

Business English

Your working notebook for the whole course. Build the phrases, models and habits for emails, calls, meetings, presentations, negotiations, reports and interviews, and track your progress toward your own workplace goals.

4 modules • 12 lessons

Phrases • models • role-plays • I can...

Name: _____

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Professional Communication Foundations

Four classes to give you a clear starting point and the three tools you use every working day. First, find out what you need English for at work and set your goals. Then learn to control register and tone, write clear professional emails, and handle phone and video calls with confidence.

Lessons 1.1-1.3

Classes C1-C4

Level B1+

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Read, Write, Listen, Say, With a partner** or **In groups**. In role-plays, you practice real work situations, then get feedback on four things: **Task & Purpose, Register & Tone, Language Range & Accuracy, and Organization & Delivery**.

You never have to share personal information: your employer, your job, your salary or your status. When a task asks about your work, use your real job, **or** a role card from the side table, **or** a job you invent. All three are equally good.

◆ READ — THE COURSE MAP

Week 1	C1 Welcome, needs survey and diagnostic · C2 Lesson 1.1 Register, tone and first impressions
Week 2	C3 Lesson 1.2 Emails and messaging · C4 Lesson 1.3 Telephoning and video calls
Weeks 3–4	C5–C7 Module 2: Meetings, networking, diplomatic communication · C8 Midpoint Performance Check
Weeks 5–6	C9–C11 Module 3: Presentations, negotiations, pitching
Weeks 7–8	C12–C14 Module 4: Reports, proposals, CVs and interviews, review project · C15–C16 Final Assessment and celebration

Homework is the matching **online lesson** (with Listen buttons, so you can hear every model sentence) plus a page of this workbook.

◆ READ AND SIGN — HOW WE WORK TOGETHER

Your teacher promises:

- ◆ Your results are private. They will never be shared or compared.
- ◆ You will get honest feedback on what is working and what to focus on.
- ◆ You never have to share personal information. A role card is always fine.
- ◆ Every mistake in this room is useful. We correct the language, never the person.

I will try to:

- ◆ ☐ do the online lesson and the workbook page before the next class
- ◆ ☐ use one new phrase at work (or in real life) every week
- ◆ ☐ speak in role-plays, even when my English isn't perfect
- ◆ ☐ give my classmates kind, useful feedback
- ◆ ☐ tell my teacher if I miss a class, and catch up with the online lesson

Our class agreements (we decide these together):

1. _____ 2. _____

Signed: _____ Date: _____

◆ READ — ABOUT TODAY

Today you complete a **workplace-needs survey** (which situations you use English in, and how confident you feel) and a short **diagnostic**: a **reply email** and a **3-minute speaking sample** with your teacher (introduce yourself or your role card, then leave a short phone message). The diagnostic is a **map, not a verdict**. It shows where to start. Your results come back privately by Class 3.

◆ WITH A PARTNER – WARM-UP: THREE WAYS TO ASK

Rank these from **most formal (1)** to **least formal (3)**. Then decide: which one would you send to a client, to your manager, and to a close colleague?

A. Could you send that over when you get a sec? _____

B. I would be grateful if you could forward the document at your earliest convenience. _____

C. Could you send me the document, please? _____

Client: _____ Manager: _____ Close colleague: _____

◆ WRITE – MY GOALS

Write three goals. Use this frame: *By ___, I want to be able to ___ in English when I ___.*

Example: *By Class 8, I want to be able to leave a clear phone message for a supplier without writing it first.*

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

How confident do I feel today? (1 = not at all · 4 = very)

Emails and messages	1 2 3 4	Phone and video calls	1 2 3 4
Meetings	1 2 3 4	Small talk and networking	1 2 3 4
Presentations and negotiations	1 2 3 4	CVs and job interviews	1 2 3 4

◆ WRITE – MY PROGRESS TRACKER (PRIVATE)

Each task is scored on four criteria, from 1 to 5. Write your scores here each time, then write your next focus.

	Task & Purpose	Register & Tone	Language Range & Accuracy	Organization & Delivery	Total /20	My next focus
Diagnostic writing (C1)						
Diagnostic speaking (C1)						

Performance Check writing (C8)						
Performance Check speaking (C8)						
Final writing (C15)						
Final speaking (C15–C16)						

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which work situation in English is most important for you right now? How did today's diagnostic feel?

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY PHRASES

register	tone	formal	neutral
friendly-professional	courteous	blunt	a softener
to hedge	positive framing	a first impression	rapport
an elevator pitch	to mirror (the room)		

register = how formal your language is · **tone** = the attitude your words show (warm, firm, unsure...) · **courteous** = polite and respectful · **blunt** = too direct, so it sounds rude · **to hedge** = to make something softer or less certain (*just, perhaps, a little*) · **rapport** = a good, friendly working relationship · **an elevator pitch** = a short introduction to you and your work · **to mirror** = to match the formality of the people around you

◆ LANGUAGE BOX – THE REGISTER SPECTRUM

Register	When to use it	Making a request
Formal	first contact, senior or external people, official documents, bad news	I would be grateful if you could send me the report by Friday.
Neutral (the safe default)	most everyday work; colleagues you know a little	Could you send me the report by Friday, please?
Friendly-professional	close colleagues; a warm, established relationship	Could you send the report over by Friday? Thanks!
Too casual (avoid at work)	—	send me the report by fri

More formal	I would like... · do not, cannot · request, assistance, regarding · Dear Ms. Alvarez, ... Sincerely,
Less formal	I'd like... · don't, can't · ask, help, about · Hi Sara, ... Best,

Three softeners (one is usually enough): **1. A modal question:** *Could you...? · Would you be able to...? · Would it be possible to...?* **2. A hedge:** *just · a little · perhaps · when you get a chance* **3. Positive framing** (say what you can do): *I can have it ready by Monday.* (not only *I can't do it today.*)

Careful: "Could you possibly maybe send it sometime if that's OK?" has too many softeners. It sounds unsure. Be polite **and** clear.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 1: RANK THE REGISTER

Write **1** (most formal), **2** or **3** (least formal).

Set 1. a) Can we meet tomorrow? _____ b) Would it be possible to arrange a meeting tomorrow?
_____ c) Free tomorrow for a quick chat? _____

Set 2. a) Thanks for your help with this. _____ b) Thank you for your assistance in this matter.
_____ c) Thanks a million! _____

Set 3. a) I'm afraid I won't be able to attend. _____ b) Can't make it, sorry! _____ c)
Unfortunately, I will be unable to attend the meeting. _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: FORMAL, NEUTRAL OR FRIENDLY?

Write **F** (formal), **N** (neutral) or **FP** (friendly-professional).

1. Dear Mr. Chen, _____ 2. Thanks! Speak soon. _____

3. I would like to request a copy of the contract. _____ 4. Could you check this for me?

5. Just a quick one: are you free at 3? _____ 6. Please do not hesitate to contact me. _____

7. Let me know if you have any questions. _____ 8. Happy to help anytime! _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: SOFTEN THE TONE

Rewrite each line so it sounds professional and courteous. Use one softener. For number 5, use positive framing.

1. Give me an update. → _____

2. That idea won't work. → _____

3. I need this by 3. → _____

4. I want a meeting with your manager. → _____

5. No, we can't deliver on Friday. → _____

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 4: TWO FIRST MEETINGS

Rafael, from Northwind Logistics, visits a client, Brightline Foods. You will hear the same meeting twice: first badly, then well.

1. Which meeting makes the better first impression? Meeting _____

2. Write two things Rafael does wrong in Meeting 1. _____

3. In Meeting 2, what is Rafael's job? _____

4. Karen introduces her colleague: "_____ I _____ you to my colleague?"

5. What does Dev do at Brightline Foods? _____

6. Karen says, "Please, call me Karen." What does Rafael answer? _____

Tick the phrases you hear in Meeting 2: ☐ It's a pleasure to meet you. ☐ Likewise. ☐ How do you do? ☐ Thanks for making the time. ☐ I've heard great things about... ☐ Have you two met?

◆ **WRITE – EXERCISE 5: RESPOND NATURALLY**

Match each line (1–6) to the best response (a–f).

1. Nice to meet you.	a) How do you do?
2. How do you do?	b) No, I don't think we have. I'm Mei.
3. Please, call me Sam.	c) Very smooth, thanks. The train was on time.
4. Have you two met?	d) Nice to meet you too.
5. Thanks for making the time.	e) Thanks, Sam. And please call me Lena.
6. How was your trip?	f) Not at all. It's good to finally meet you in person.

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____ 4 _____ 5 _____ 6 _____

◆ **READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: MOVING TO FIRST NAMES**

Lena: Excuse me, are you Mr. Okafor, from Crestview Hotels?

Sam: Yes, that's right. Sam Okafor.

Lena: I'm Lena Ortiz, from Kestrel Design. We spoke on the phone last week. It's great to finally meet you in person.

Sam: Likewise, Ms. Ortiz. Thank you for coming.

Lena: Please, call me Lena.

Sam: Then please call me Sam. Have you met my colleague? This is Mei Lin, who looks after our events.

Mei: Nice to meet you, Lena.

Lena: Nice to meet you too, Mei. I'm responsible for the design of your new brochure, so I think we'll be working together quite closely.

Mei: That's great. I have a few questions about the photos, actually.

Lena: Of course. Would it be possible to go through them after the meeting?

Underline the moment they move to first names. Circle the phrase Sam uses to introduce Mei. Find one softened request.

◆ **WRITE AND SAY – MY ELEVATOR PITCH**

Name + role + what you do / value + a friendly hook. 3–4 sentences. Use your real job, a role card, or a job you invent.

Model: *"Hi, I'm Ana Ruiz. I'm a marketing analyst, and I help our sales team find the right customers using data. I understand we'll be working together on the launch. I'm really looking forward to it."*

Hi, I'm _____. I'm a / an _____ at _____,
where I _____.

Hook: _____

Say it to a partner twice. Partner: one thing to **keep** _____ one thing to **change**

◆ IN GROUPS OF 3 – THE WELCOME RECEPTION

Your teacher gives your group a situation card. Take a role: **Host** (welcome the visitor, introduce your colleague, keep the conversation going), **Visitor** (greet, give your pitch, ask a question back) or **Colleague** (respond, add one fact about yourself, suggest a next step). Five minutes, then change roles. In round 3, one person observes with the checklist.

Useful: *You must be... · It's a pleasure to meet you. · Can I introduce you to...? · This is..., who... · Likewise. · I've heard great things about... · So what brings you here? · It was great to meet you. I'll let you get back to the others.*

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

You're emailing a client for the very first time. Which opening fits best?

A) Hey! Quick one for you...

B) Need to talk about the contract.

C) Dear Ms. Alvarez, I would like to introduce myself...

2

Which response best softens a refusal while staying professional?

A) No, I can't.

B) I'm afraid I can't make Tuesday, but I'm free Thursday if that helps.

C) Um, maybe I possibly might not be able to, if that's perhaps OK?

3

Which is the best neutral request to a colleague?

A) Could you send me the figures when you have a moment?

B) Send me the figures.

C) I would be most grateful if you could possibly perhaps send the figures, if it is not too much trouble.

4

A senior visitor says, "How do you do?" What do you answer?

A) I'm fine, thank you.

B) How do you do?

C) Not bad, and you?

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ choose formal, neutral or friendly-professional register for the person and situation
- ◆ ☐ turn a blunt line into a courteous one, with one softener
- ◆ ☐ greet people, introduce myself and others, and respond naturally
- ◆ ☐ move to first names when I'm invited
- ◆ ☐ give a short, natural elevator pitch

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of one message or conversation that didn't land well. How would you say it now, and which register will be your default?

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY PHRASES

a subject line	a greeting	a sign-off	the ask
a deadline	attached	to follow up	to chase (politely)
CC / BCC	Reply / Reply All	a thread	FYI

the ask = what you want the reader to do · **to follow up / to chase** = to write again because you haven't had an answer · **CC** = people who need to know but don't need to act · **BCC** = hidden copy: other readers can't see these addresses · **a thread** = a chain of messages on one topic · **FYI** = for your information (no action needed)

◆ LANGUAGE BOX – THE EMAIL AND ITS FRAME

Seven parts, in this order: 1 subject line (clear and specific) → 2 greeting → 3 opening line (your reason) → 4 body (**one** purpose + a clear ask with a deadline) → 5 closing line (the next step) → 6 sign-off (matches the greeting) → 7 name and signature.

Register	Greeting	Sign-off
Formal	Dear Mr. / Ms. + family name, · Dear Sir or Madam,	Sincerely, (US) · Yours sincerely, (UK, named person) · Yours faithfully, (UK, after "Dear Sir or Madam")
Neutral	Dear Sara, · Hi Sara,	Kind regards, · Best regards,
Friendly-professional	Hi Sara, · Hello Sara,	Best, · Thanks,

Note: In modern email, "Dear Mr. Chen, ... Kind regards," or "Best regards," is also very common and polite. **Never** mix a formal greeting with a very casual sign-off ("Dear Sir ... Cheers!").

Opening	I'm writing to confirm / ask about / let you know... · Thank you for your email of March 3. · Further to our conversation, ...
Request	Could you please send me...? · I would be grateful if you could... · Would it be possible to...? · I'd appreciate it if you could confirm by Friday.
Attachment	Please find attached the report. · I've attached the figures for your review.
Following up	I'm just following up on my email below. · As a gentle reminder, the deadline is Friday.

Bad news	Unfortunately, we won't be able to... · I'm afraid there's been a delay. · Please accept my apologies for...
Closing	Please let me know if you have any questions. · I look forward to hearing from you. · Thanks in advance for your help.

◆ READ — A MODEL EMAIL

Subject: Training room booking for March 18 — confirmation needed by March 6

Dear Ms. Grant,

Thank you for sending your conference brochure last week.

We would like to book your Harbor Room for a one-day training session on Wednesday, March 18, for 20 people. I would be grateful if you could confirm availability and the full price, including lunch and coffee breaks, by Friday, March 6.

Please find attached our draft schedule for the day.

Please let me know if you need any further details. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Sofia Brandt

Office Manager, Kestrel Design

1. Write the numbers 1–7 (the seven parts) next to the email. 2. What is the **one** purpose?

3. Underline the ask. What is the deadline? _____ 4. Is the register consistent? Which words show it?

◆ WRITE — EXERCISE 1: PUT THE EMAIL IN ORDER

Write the letters in the correct order.

a) Best regards, Tomasz Nowak, Northwind Logistics

b) Dear Mr. Patel,

c) Subject: Delivery for order #5216 — new date: Tuesday, May 12

d) Could you confirm that someone will be available to receive it between 9 and 11 a.m.?

e) I'm writing to let you know that your delivery has been moved to Tuesday, May 12.

f) Please let me know if you have any questions.

Order: _____

◆ WRITE — EXERCISE 2: MATCH THE PHRASE TO ITS FUNCTION

Write: **opening** · **request** · **attachment** · **follow-up** · **bad news** · **closing**

1. Further to our conversation this morning, ... _____
2. I've attached the signed contract. _____
3. Would it be possible to move the call to 2 p.m.? _____
4. As a gentle reminder, the invoice is due on Friday. _____
5. Regrettably, the item is out of stock. _____
6. Thanks in advance for your help. _____
7. I know you're busy. Any update when you get a chance? _____
8. I'd appreciate it if you could confirm by Monday. _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: FIX THE SUBJECT LINE

Each subject line is weak. Read what the email is about, then write a specific, useful subject line.

1. "Hi" (you want a colleague to review your slides by Wednesday) → _____
2. "Question" (you have a question about invoice #3390) → _____
3. (blank) (your manager must approve weekend overtime by 4 p.m. today) → _____
4. "Meeting" (you want to move Thursday's team meeting to Friday at 10 a.m.) →

5. "URGENT!!!" (the warehouse is closed on Monday for an inspection; no action needed) →

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: REWRITE THE BLUNT EMAIL

This internal email to a colleague, Marco, is too blunt and has no structure. Rewrite it with a specific subject line, a greeting, a softened ask with a deadline, a diplomatic comment about the slides, and a sign-off.

Subject: stuff

send me the sales numbers. need them today. also the slides are wrong.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: CHAT OR EMAIL? REPLY OR REPLY ALL?

Write the best choice: **chat** · **email** · **CC** · **BCC** · **Reply** · **Reply All**

1. You need a colleague's quick yes or no on the lunch order in the next ten minutes. _____

2. You're sending a price quote to a new client. _____
3. Your manager should know about a small delay but doesn't need to do anything. _____
4. 32 people received an announcement. You want to thank the sender. _____
5. You're emailing 60 workshop participants from different companies who don't know each other.

6. All four people on a project thread need to know the meeting room has changed. _____

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 6: THE MANAGER'S VOICEMAIL

Your manager, Lena, leaves you a voicemail. Take notes.

Write to (name + company)	
What we need	
Quantity and item (model)	
Deadline (and why)	
What to attach	
Register	

◆ WRITE – THE FORMAL REQUEST

Write the email from your notes. Include all seven parts.

Subject: _____

◆ WITH A PARTNER – REPLY IN ROLE

Swap workbooks. You are **Mr. Daniel Okoro** at Harbor Point Supplies. Read your partner's email and your Supplier Reply card. Write a short, formal reply below. Then give the workbook back.

Writer: read the reply. Did your email give Mr. Okoro everything he needed? ☐ yes ☐ no: I forgot

◆ SAY — SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which subject line best follows the "specific and useful" rule?

A) Budget approval needed by Thu 5 p.m.

B) Important!!

C) Budget

2

You open a formal British-style email with "Dear Sir or Madam, ". Which sign-off matches?

A) Yours faithfully,

B) Yours sincerely,

C) Cheers,

3

An email about a room change went to 30 people. You want to say thank you to the sender. What do you do?

A) Reply All.

B) Forward it to your team with "Thanks!"

C) Reply only to the sender.

4

Which closing line is correct?

A) I look forward to hear from you.

B) I look forward to hearing from you.

C) I am looking forward for your reply.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ write an email in the seven-part order
- ◆ ☐ write a specific subject line and one clear ask with a deadline
- ◆ ☐ match my greeting and sign-off to one register
- ◆ ☐ use phrases for opening, requests, attachments, follow-ups, bad news and closing
- ◆ ☐ choose chat or email, CC or BCC, Reply or Reply All

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of an email that got no reply or a confused reply. Which of the seven parts was missing, and how would you fix it now?

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY PHRASES

to put someone through

to hold (the line)

to take a message

to leave a message

to call someone back

to read back

Bear with me.

to spell

a callback

on mute

to break up

to share your screen

to put someone through = to connect a caller to another person · **to hold** = to wait on the phone · **to read back** = to repeat details to check them · **Bear with me.** = Please wait a moment. · **to break up** = (sound) to keep cutting out on a bad connection

◆ LANGUAGE BOX – THE CALL, STAGE BY STAGE

Stage	Receiver	Caller
1 Answer / identify	Good morning, Northwind Logistics, Ana speaking. How can I help?	Hello, this is Rafael Mendes from Brightline Foods.
2 Purpose	May I ask what it's regarding?	I'm calling about... · Could I speak to..., please? · Is this a good time to talk?
3 Connect / hold	I'll put you through. · Could you hold the line, please? · Bear with me a moment. · Thanks for holding.	Sure, thanks.
4 Unavailable	I'm afraid she's in a meeting / not at her desk / away until Monday. Can I take a message?	When is a good time to call back?
5 Message	Can I take your name and number? · Let me read that back to you...	Could you ask her to call me back at (312) 555-0147? · Could you let him know that...?
6 End	I'll make sure she gets the message. Thanks for calling.	Thanks for your help. Have a good day.

Say it clearly. Phone numbers in groups: *three-one-two · five-five-five · oh-one-four-seven*. Two of the same: *double seven*. 0 = *oh* or *zero*. 15 or 50? Say *fifteen*, *one-five*. Dates: *the fourteenth*, *one-four*. Email: *s dot brandt at kestrel design dot com*.

Spell with words: A Alpha · B Bravo · C Charlie · D Delta · E Echo · F Foxtrot · G Golf · H Hotel · I India · J Juliet · K Kilo · L Lima · M Mike · N November · O Oscar · P Papa · Q Quebec · R Romeo · S Sierra · T Tango · U Uniform · V Victor · W Whiskey · X X-ray · Y Yankee · Z Zulu. Any clear word is fine: "D as in David."

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 1: MATCH THE PHRASE TO THE STAGE

Write the stage number (1–6) from the Language box.

- a) Could you hold the line, please? _____ b) She's away until Monday. _____
- c) Good afternoon, Harbor Point Supplies, Tom speaking. _____ d) I'm calling about last month's invoice. _____
- e) Could you ask him to call me back at (312) 555-0147? _____ f) That's everything, thanks very much. Have a good day. _____
- g) I'll put you through. _____ h) Is this a good time to talk? _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: PUT THE CALL IN ORDER

- a) "Of course. Can I take your name and number?"
- b) "Good morning, Kestrel Design, Priya speaking. How can I help?"
- c) "Thanks for your help. Bye for now."
- d) "Hello, this is Rafael Mendes from Northwind Logistics. Could I speak to Joanna Wexford, please?"
- e) "It's Rafael Mendes, M-E-N-D-E-S, at (312) 555-0147."
- f) "Bear with me a moment... I'm afraid Joanna's in a meeting. Can I take a message?"
- g) "Let me read that back: Rafael Mendes, Northwind Logistics, at (312) 555-0147, about the delivery schedule. Is that right?"
- h) "Yes, please. Could you ask her to call me back about the delivery schedule?"

Order: _____

◆ LISTEN – DICTATION: NAMES, NUMBERS, DATES

Write exactly what you hear.

1. Name: _____ 2. Phone: _____
3. Order number: _____ 4. Quantity and date: _____
5. Email: _____ 6. Meeting: _____

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 3: TAKE THE MESSAGE

You answer the phone at Brightline Foods. Marcus Lee is not available. Complete the message pad.

For	Marcus Lee	Time of call	
-----	------------	--------------	--

Caller's name (spelling!)			
Company		Phone	
About			
Key details (numbers, dates)			
Callback / next step			

◆ WRITE AND SAY – EXERCISE 4: FIX THE MESSAGE

A colleague left this note on your desk: "**Someone called about an order. Call them back.**"

(a) What is missing? _____

(b) Write a usable message (invent the details): _____

(c) Say this aloud to a partner, phone-style. Your partner reads it back. **Name:** Bexley · **Number:** (415) 555-0126

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: VIDEO-CALL TROUBLE

Match each problem (1–6) to the best phrase (a–f).

1. Someone is talking, but you can't hear them.	a) Sorry, you go ahead.
2. You and a colleague start talking at the same time.	b) I'll share my screen so we're all looking at the same thing.
3. A colleague's voice keeps cutting out.	c) I think you're on mute.
4. A colleague's picture has frozen and they don't answer.	d) Priya, did you want to come in on that?
5. You want everyone to see your slides.	e) Sorry, you're breaking up a little. Could you repeat that?
6. A quiet colleague looks like she wants to speak.	f) I think we've lost you.

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____ 4 _____ 5 _____ 6 _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: OPENING A VIDEO MEETING

Chair: Hi everyone, thanks for joining. Can everyone hear me OK?

Tom: Loud and clear.

Chair: Great. I think we're just waiting for Priya... oh, there she is. Priya, I think you're on mute.

Priya: Sorry about that. Can you hear me now?

Chair: Perfectly. Right, shall we get started? I'll share my screen so we're all looking at the same agenda. Can you all see that?

Tom: Yes, that's come up fine.

Chair: Wonderful. Let's use the chat for any questions as we go, and I'll pause after each item. Tom, over to you for item one.

Find: an audio check · a mute problem · a screen share · one ground rule · a handover by name.

◆ WITH A PARTNER – BACK-TO-BACK PHONE CALLS

Sit back to back. Use your A or B card. The **receiver** writes the message here and reads it back before ending the call. Then change roles.

Message pad · Call 1	
For	
From / company	
Phone	
About	
Callback / next step	

Message pad · Call 2	
For	
From / company	
Phone	
About	
Callback / next step	

Caller: check the pad against your card. Everything correct? ☐ yes ☐ no: _____

◆ IN GROUPS OF 4 – OPEN A VIDEO MEETING

The **chair** opens the meeting. The others have a secret problem card: act it, don't read it. The chair must:

- ◆ ☐ greet everyone and check the audio
- ◆ ☐ handle every problem with a natural phrase (not silence)
- ◆ ☐ share the screen or the agenda
- ◆ ☐ set one ground rule (for example, questions in the chat)
- ◆ ☐ hand over to someone by name

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A caller asks for a colleague who is in a meeting. Which response fits best?

- A) One moment, I'll put you through.
- B) He's not here. Call back later.
- C) I'm afraid he's in a meeting right now. Can I take a message?

2

You didn't quite catch a client's phone number. What's the most professional thing to do?

- A) Write down your best guess and move on so you don't seem slow.
- B) "Sorry, could you repeat the last three digits? Let me read it back to check."
- C) Say nothing and hope it arrives in an email later.

3

What is the best way to start a call that you make?

- A) This is Ana from Northwind Logistics.
- B) I am Ana. Who are you?
- C) Hello, here is Ana speaking from Northwind.

4

On a video call, a colleague's audio keeps cutting out. What do you say?

- A) Nothing. Pretend you heard and continue.
- B) "Your internet is terrible."
- C) "Sorry, you're breaking up a little. Could you repeat that last part?"

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ answer and make a business call with the right phrase for each stage
- ◆ ☐ take and leave a message with name, company, number, reason and callback
- ◆ ☐ spell a name with clear words and say numbers and dates clearly

- ◆ ☐ read the important details back before I end a call
- ◆ ☐ open a video meeting and handle mute and connection problems

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Remember a call or video meeting that felt awkward.
Which habit (the read-back, signposting a hold, or
smiling as you speak) will you make automatic first?

Meetings & Interpersonal Skills

Three lessons on speaking with people at work: taking part in meetings and chairing them, starting conversations and building professional relationships, and saying difficult things clearly and kindly. Then show what you can do in the Midpoint Performance Check.

Lessons 2.1-2.3

Classes C5-C8

Level B1+

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Listen**, **Read**, **Write**, **Say** or **With a partner**. In every lesson you practice the phrases first, then use them in a **role-play**: a meeting, a networking event or a difficult conversation. You never need to talk about your real employer, your job situation or your salary. You can use your real job, a past job, or a **role card** with a fictional job and company. It is your choice.

One idea connects the whole module: **acknowledge first, then act**. Show people you have heard them before you say your own point.

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY WORDS

— the person who <i>to chair</i> runs the <i>a</i> meeting <i>meeting</i> (also a verb): chair	— a person who takes part (also participant	— the list of topics, sent before the meeting agenda	— one topic on the agenda item
— the written record of a meeting minutes	action point — who does what by when	— "any other business": the last agenda item AOB	— going as planned, on time on track
— stop discussing it now, come back later park (a topic)	— discuss it after the meeting, with fewer people take it offline	— send a document to everyone circulate	— final approval sign-off

◆ SAY — KEY PHRASES

Give your opinion

In my view, ...

It seems to me that...

I'd suggest (that) we...

From my perspective, ...

Agree

Absolutely.

That's a good point.

I'm with you on that.

I completely agree.

Disagree politely (acknowledge, then differ)

I see your point, but...

I'm not sure I agree.

Have we considered...?

I take your point, though I'd add...

Could I offer a different view?

Ask for clarification • check understanding

Could you clarify what you mean by...?

Sorry, could you expand on that?

Just so I'm clear, are you saying...?

So the plan is to..., is that right?

Turn-taking: interrupt, hold the floor, bring others in

Sorry to interrupt, but...

Can I just come in here?

Just to build on that...

If I could just finish...

What do you think, Sara?

Chair the meeting

Shall we get started?

The purpose of today's meeting is...

First on the agenda is...

Let's move on to...

Let's park that and take it offline.

So, to summarize, ...

Are we all agreed?

To recap the action points, ...

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — POLITE MEETING LANGUAGE

Function	Too direct (avoid)	Neutral: safe at work	More formal
Interrupt	Wait. Stop. I want to speak.	Sorry to interrupt, but... · Can I just come in here?	If I could just come in on that point...
Disagree	No, that's wrong.	I see your point, but I'm not sure I agree.	I take your point, although I'd see it slightly differently.
Clarify	What? Say it again.	Sorry, could you expand on that?	Could you clarify what you mean by...?
Suggest	We do it my way.	Why don't we...? · How about...?	I'd suggest that we...

Suggestions	Why don't we ask ...? · Shall we ask ...? · How about asking ...? · I'd suggest (that) we ask ... · I suggest asking ... (not: I suggest to ask)
Agree	<i>Agree</i> is a verb: I agree. · Do you agree? (not: I am agree)
Discuss	discuss the budget (not: discuss about) · but: talk about the budget
Meeting verbs	have / hold a meeting · attend a meeting · chair a meeting · take the minutes
Action points	Name + will + verb + by + time: <i>Tom will call the client by Thursday.</i>

◆ READ — THE MODEL: AN AGENDA

AGENDA — Weekly Project Sync · Kestrel Design · Tuesday 10:00 (30 min)	
1	Northwind website launch — are we on track for the 12th? (10 min)

2	Budget update (10 min)
3	Any other business (5 min)
Attendees: Lena (chair), Marco, Priya, Tom · Minutes: Lena	

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: THE WEEKLY SYNC

Your teacher reads part of the meeting. **First listening:** answer a and b.

a) What is the purpose of the meeting? _____

b) What did they decide about the launch date? _____

Second listening: complete the action points.

Who	What	By when
Tom	_____	_____
_____	finish the last two pages	_____
Priya	_____	_____

c) Tick (✓) the phrases you hear.

☐ 1 Sorry to interrupt, but... ☐ 2 I see your point, but... ☐ 3 Could I offer a different view? ☐ 4 Let's hear from Tom on this.

☐ 5 Just to build on... ☐ 6 Could you clarify what you mean by...? ☐ 7 Let me just finish my point. ☐ 8 Let's park...

◆ READ – EXERCISE 2: WHAT DOES EACH PHRASE DO?

Write the function: **O** opinion · **A** agree · **D** disagree politely · **Cl** clarify · **T** turn-taking (interrupt or hold the floor) · **Ch** chair.

1. May I jump in? _____ 2. I'm not convinced that... _____ 3. From my perspective, ... _____

4. That's item one covered. _____ 5. Could you expand on that? _____ 6. I'm with you on that. _____

7. If I could just finish... _____ 8. If you ask me, ... _____ 9. Just so I'm clear, are you saying...? _____

10. Let's give everyone a chance to speak. _____ 11. I take your point, though I'd add... _____ 12. Exactly — that's my thinking too. _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: SUGGESTIONS AND COMMON MISTAKES

A. Complete with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. Why don't we _____ (ask) the client for a deadline?
2. How about _____ (use) placeholder images for now?
3. I'd suggest that we _____ (move) the launch to the 18th.
4. Shall we _____ (take) a five-minute break?
5. What if we _____ (share) the task between two people?
6. I suggest _____ (postpone) the budget discussion.

B. Find the mistake and write the correct sentence.

7. We need to discuss about the budget. _____
8. I am agree with Tom. _____
9. Can we make a meeting on Friday? _____

◆ **READ – EXERCISE 4: PUT THE CHAIR'S LINES IN ORDER**

Number the lines 1–8 in the natural order of a meeting.

- _____ a) "To recap the action points: Tom will call the client by tomorrow, and Priya will circulate the budget by Friday."
- _____ b) "Thanks, everyone, for coming. Shall we get started?"
- _____ c) "Let's move on to item two, the budget."
- _____ d) "The purpose of today's meeting is to check we're on track for the launch."
- _____ e) "So, to summarize: we keep the 12th if the photos arrive by Wednesday. Are we all agreed?"
- _____ f) "First on the agenda is the launch date. Marco, where are we?"
- _____ g) "Thanks, everyone — that was productive. I'll send the minutes around this afternoon."
- _____ h) "Let's hear from Tom on this."

◆ **WRITE – EXERCISE 5: MAKE IT POLITE**

Rewrite each line so it is professional and courteous. Acknowledge first, and use a signal or a softener.

1. (interrupt) "Stop — I want to say something." _____
2. (disagree) "No, that's wrong." _____
3. (clarify) "What? Say it again." _____
4. (disagree + suggest) "Your idea is bad. We should do it differently." _____
5. (chair) "You're talking too much. Let other people speak." _____

◆ **WITH A PARTNER – MEETING PLANNER**

Use your scenario card from your teacher, or plan a meeting at a workplace you know (real or imagined).

Chair: write the agenda. **Participants:** write your position and three phrases you will use.

AGENDA — _____ · Date / time: _____ (10 min)		
1	_____	(_____ min)
2	_____	(_____ min)
3	Any other business	(_____ min)

My role: ☐ chair ☐ participant ☐ observer My position / goal: _____

Three phrases I will use: _____

After the meeting — action points

Who	What	By when

◆ SAY — SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A colleague is speaking, but you have an urgent point. What is the most professional way to come in?

A) "Sorry to interrupt, but can I just come in here?"

B) "Stop, I want to say something."

C) Say nothing and hope to raise it later.

2

Which one is a complete action point?

A) "We should look at the budget."

B) "Priya — circulate the updated budget — by Friday."

C) "Budget: discussed."

3

Which phrase does the chair use to close the meeting?

A) "First on the agenda is..."

B) "To recap the action points, ..."

C) "Could you expand on that?"

4

Which sentence is correct?

A) I suggest to wait until Monday.

B) How about to wait until Monday?

C) I'd suggest we wait until Monday.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ explain what an agenda, minutes and an action point are
- ◆ ☐ give an opinion, agree, and disagree politely (acknowledge, then differ)
- ◆ ☐ ask for clarification and check that I understand
- ◆ ☐ interrupt politely with a signal, and bring a quieter person in
- ◆ ☐ chair a short meeting from an agenda and close it with action points (who / what / by when)

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of a meeting where you stayed silent but wanted to speak. Which phrase from today would you use now, and when?

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY WORDS

small talk — friendly, light conversation	rapport — a good, comfortable connection with someone	networking — meeting people to build professional contacts	opener — the first line of a conversation
open question — a question that needs more than "yes" or "no"	free information — extra detail you give, so the other person has something to ask about	common ground — something you share (a city, a role, a challenge, a hobby)	mingle — move around and talk to different people at an event
exit line — a polite way to end a conversation	follow up — contact someone again after meeting them (noun: <i>a follow-up</i>)	stay in touch — keep contact	turnout — the number of people who come to an event

◆ SAY — KEY PHRASES

Open the conversation (shared context)

Great turnout, isn't it?

How are you finding the conference so far?

Have you been to one of these before?

What did you think of the keynote?

How do you know the host?

Keep it going (the rapport engine)

Oh really?

That sounds interesting — tell me more.

How did you get into that?

What was that like?

That must be challenging.

Same here, actually!

Introduce yourself · join a group · exchange contacts

I don't think we've met — I'm...

Mind if I join you?

Do you have a card?

What's the best way to reach you?

Let me give you my details.

Exit gracefully

It's been great talking — I should go and say hello to a few others.

I won't keep you.

Let's stay in touch.

I'm going to grab another coffee, but it was really good to meet you.

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — QUESTIONS THAT KEEP A CONVERSATION GOING

Closed → open	Are you enjoying it? (→ "Yes.") → What are you enjoying most so far? · Start with How, What, Which, Why .
How are you finding...?	= What's your opinion of it so far? · How are you finding the new job / the city / the conference ?
Tags for agreement	Great turnout, isn't it? · It's busy today, isn't it? · Your voice goes down at the end: you expect "Yes, it is!"
Free information	answer + extra + question back : "I'm an accountant — I mostly work with small businesses, which keeps it interesting. How about you?"
Experience	Have you been to one of these before? · I've worked in purchasing for six years / since 2019. (not: I am working here since six years)
Same idea, three registers	Chat : "Let's stay in touch!" · Follow-up email : "I'd love to stay in touch." · Formal letter : "I would welcome the opportunity to remain in contact." (too formal for networking)

◆ LISTEN — EXERCISE 1: TWO CONVERSATIONS AT A COFFEE BREAK

Your teacher reads two conversations between Hamid and Joanna at a business event.

Version 1. Why does the conversation stop so quickly? Write two reasons.

Version 2. Complete the notes.

Hamid's opener	_____
----------------	-------

Two follow-up questions	1 _____ 2 _____
Joanna's free information	_____
Hamid's free information	_____
Their common ground	_____
How they exchange contacts	_____
Joanna's exit line	_____
The next step	_____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: OPEN IT UP

Change each closed question into an open question.

1. Are you enjoying the conference? → _____
2. Do you like your job? → _____
3. Did you come by train? → _____
4. Was the keynote good? → _____
5. Are you busy at the moment? → _____
6. Do you know the host? → _____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 3: SAFE OR RISKY?

You have just met someone at an industry event. Write **S** (safe) or **R** (risky).

1. the event and the speakers _____
2. the food and the coffee _____
3. how much they earn _____
4. how they got into their field _____
5. their religion _____
6. their weekend plans _____
7. their age _____
8. gossip about a competitor _____
9. their trip to the event _____
10. their health _____

With a partner: which topics are "it depends"? (For example: family, sport, the weather.) In workplaces you know, what is normal to talk about with someone new?

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: RESCUE THE DEAD-END REPLY

Each reply stops the conversation. Rewrite it: **answer + free information + question back**. You can use your real job or a role card.

1. "What do you do?" → "I'm an accountant." _____

2. "Have you come far?" → "Not really." _____
3. "How are you finding the conference?" → "It's fine." _____
4. "How do you know the host?" → "We worked together." _____

◆ READ — EXERCISE 5: THE GRACEFUL EXIT

Mark each exit ✓ (good) or ✗ (weak). For each ✗, write why.

- _____ 1. "Anyway, I'm bored. I'm going to talk to someone else."
- _____ 2. "It's been great talking to you — I should go and catch a few other people, but let's stay in touch."
- _____ 3. (You look at your phone and walk away.)
- _____ 4. "I won't keep you — I'm sure you want to mingle too. Shall we swap cards?"
- _____ 5. "I'm going to grab another coffee, but it was really good to meet you."
- _____ 6. "OK. Bye."

◆ READ — THE MODEL: A FOLLOW-UP EMAIL

Hamid writes to Joanna the day after the event. Label the parts: **A** reminder + something specific from the chat · **B** keeps a promise · **C** a light next step (no pressure) · **D** sign-off with role.

Subject: Great to meet you at the Logistics Expo	
Hi Joanna,	
_____	It was great to meet you at the Regional Logistics Expo yesterday. I really enjoyed our chat in the coffee line about career changes and fresh-food deliveries.
_____	As promised, I've attached some information about the new tracking tool we're testing for food customers. I'd be curious to hear whether it could help with your new system.
_____	If you'd like to talk it through, I'd be happy to set up a short call next week. No pressure at all.
_____	Best regards, Hamid Karimi Route Planner, Northwind Logistics

◆ WITH A PARTNER — MY NETWORKING TOOLKIT AND THE MINGLE

Use your identity card from your teacher, or your own real or past job.

My opener: _____

My three safe topics: 1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____

My introduction (name, role, a friendly hook): _____

My exit line: _____

People I met

Name	Company / role	Common ground	Follow-up idea

Write: a follow-up email (60–90 words) to one person you met. Use the model: reminder + something specific + a light next step.

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which opener invites a real answer?

A) "Are you enjoying it?"

B) "What's been the most useful session for you so far?"

C) "Nice weather."

2

You have just met someone at a networking event. Which topic is the safest?

A) their salary

B) the event and the venue

C) whether they are married and have children

3

Someone asks, "What do you do?" Which answer builds rapport best?

A) "I'm in logistics."

B) "I'm in logistics — I actually moved over from teaching last year, so it's all quite new. How about you?"

C) "Why do you ask?"

4

When is the best time to send a follow-up message?

A) within 24–48 hours

B) after about a month

C) only if they contact you first

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ start a conversation with a stranger using something we share
- ◆ ☐ ask open questions and follow-up questions, and give free information
- ◆ ☐ choose safe topics and notice when a topic is risky
- ◆ ☐ introduce myself briefly, join a group, exchange contacts and leave politely
- ◆ ☐ write a short, specific follow-up message

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

When did a conversation stop too soon for you?
Which opener, question or free information could keep it going next time?

◆ LISTEN – WARM-UP: A VOICEMAIL FROM A NEW CONTACT

You met Mei at a business event. Listen to her voicemail and take notes.

Name and company	_____	Where you met	_____
What you talked about	_____	What she wants	_____
Phone	_____	When she's free	_____

With a partner: call Mei back. Mention something specific and agree a next step.

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY WORDS

passive — not saying what you need; you lose	aggressive — blunt or rude; the other person loses	assertive — honest and respectful/ diplomatic	tactful/ diplomatic — careful not to upset people
soften — make a message gentler, not weaker	hedge — use <i>I think, perhaps, might</i> to sound open	push back — politely disagree with a plan or request	constructive feedback — specific comments that help someone improve
at capacity — completely busy; no time for more	trade-off — to get one thing, you give up another	take (something) on board — accept it and think about it	de-escalate — make a tense situation calmer

◆ LANGUAGE BOX – THE SOFTENING TOOLKIT

Stay **firm on substance** (the fact, the reason, the proposal) and **soft on delivery**. Use one or two softeners, not all of them.

Move	Form	Example
------	------	---------

Hedging	I think · perhaps · might / could	I think we might be underestimating the timeline.
Qualifiers	a slight · a little · not quite	I have a slight concern about the budget.
Question forms	Would it be possible to + verb? · Have we considered + -ing / noun?	Would it be possible to push it a week?
Distance (past forms)	I was wondering if we could ... · I was hoping...	I was hoping we could revisit the deadline.
Positive framing	say what you can do	I can definitely get you the draft by Thursday.
Prefacing	acknowledge first	I take your point, but I'd suggest...

Feedback	Situation (when / where) → Behavior (what happened) → Impact (the effect) + one honest positive + a question
Saying no	1 an alternative (I can't..., but I could...) · 2 a trade-off (Which task should slip?) · 3 buy time (Let me check and get back to you.)
Conflict	acknowledge the feeling → the problem, not the person → common ground → a way forward

◆ SAY — KEY PHRASES

Disagree and push back

I see it a little differently...

Can I offer another perspective?

I hear you, but I have some concerns about...

I'd push back gently on that, because...

Help me understand the thinking here.

Give feedback · receive feedback

Is now a good time for a bit of feedback?

One thing that worked really well was...

One thing I'd suggest for next time...

How do you feel it went?

Thanks for telling me.

Could you give me an example?

Let me take that on board.

Say no · calm things down

I'd love to help, but I'm at capacity right now.

I'm afraid I can't..., but I could...

That won't be possible by Friday — would next week work?

I understand this is frustrating.

Let's focus on the problem, not who's at fault.

We both want the same outcome here.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: TWO WAYS TO GIVE FEEDBACK

Rosa, a team leader, gives feedback to Daniel about the monthly report. Listen to the **weak** version and the **strong** version.

a) Which version would you prefer to receive? Why? _____

b) In the strong version, what is the...

honest positive?	_____
Situation?	_____
Behavior?	_____
Impact?	_____
question to Daniel?	_____
proposal?	_____
Daniel's "receiving" phrase?	_____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 2: PASSIVE, AGGRESSIVE OR ASSERTIVE?

Write P (passive), Ag (aggressive) or As (assertive).

- _____ 1. "Fine, I'll just do it myself, don't worry about it."
- _____ 2. "I hear you, but I have some concerns about the timeline — can we talk them through?"
- _____ 3. "You always leave this to the last minute."
- _____ 4. "It's okay, it doesn't matter." (It does matter.)
- _____ 5. "That's a bad idea. It'll never work."
- _____ 6. "I'd love to help, but I'm at capacity this week. Could I look at it on Monday?"
- _____ 7. "Sorry, sorry, I'm probably wrong. Forget it."
- _____ 8. "I've noticed the last two reports arrived late — can we look at what's getting in the way?"

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: ADD A SOFTENER

Rewrite each sentence with the move in brackets. Keep the message.

1. (hedging) "We're underestimating the timeline." _____
2. (qualifier) "I have a concern about the budget." _____
3. (question form) "Push the deadline back a week." _____

4. (distance) "I want to revisit the deadline." _____
5. (positive framing) "I can't send the draft until Thursday." _____
6. (prefacing) "That's not the best approach." _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: REWRITE THE BLUNT MESSAGES

Make each message diplomatic *and* assertive: acknowledge, soften a little, keep the real message, and offer a way forward.

1. To your manager (disagree): "We shouldn't take this client. It's a waste of time."

2. To a colleague (say no): "I can't cover your shift. Ask someone else."

3. To a teammate (feedback): "You talk over people in meetings."

4. To a supplier (complaint): "This is the third mistake. Fix it."

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 5: CALMING A COMPLAINT

Ms. Kovacs from Silverleaf Hotels calls Sam at Northwind Logistics about a late delivery.

- a) What is the problem? _____
- b) Number the steps in the order Sam uses them, and write the phrase he uses.

Order	Step	Sam's phrase
_____	common ground	_____
_____	a way forward	_____

_____	acknowledge the feeling	_____
_____	the problem, not the person	_____

c) What will Sam do, and by when? _____

◆ WITH A PARTNER – HARD-CONVERSATION PLANNER

Use your card from your teacher. Plan your opening in one minute, then talk. You can adapt a card for a situation you want to practice, but you don't need to share it.

Situation (from the card): _____

Acknowledge: I understand / I see / I appreciate _____

My view or SBI: I see it a little differently, because / In... (S), ... (B), and... (I) _____

A way forward: Would it be possible to / What if we / I could _____

Observer notes: ☐ acknowledged first ☐ one or two softeners ☐ the real message was clear ☐ a way forward was agreed ☐ no "always / never / you're..."

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A colleague suggests an approach you think is risky. Which response is assertive?

A) "Sure, sounds good, let's go with yours." (while privately worried)

B) "That's a bad idea, it'll never work."

C) "I see it a little differently — I'm worried about the support cost. Can we look at it together?"

2

Which sentence is about behavior, not the person?

A) "You're careless."

B) "The last two reports arrived after the deadline."

C) "You never care about deadlines."

3

You really can't take on a request. Which reply is best?

A) "I'd love to help, but I'm at capacity this week. I could review the draft on Friday if that's useful?"

B) "No, ask someone else."

C) "Um, okay, I'll try to squeeze it in somehow..." (knowing you can't)

4

A client is angry about a late delivery. What should you do first?

A) explain whose fault it was

B) acknowledge the feeling

C) offer a discount immediately

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ tell passive, aggressive and assertive messages apart
- ◆ ☐ soften a message with one or two moves and still keep my point clear
- ◆ ☐ disagree or push back with a reason and a proposal
- ◆ ☐ give feedback with Situation → Behavior → Impact, and receive feedback without defending
- ◆ ☐ say no politely and calm a complaint

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Under pressure, is your usual style passive, aggressive or assertive? Which phrase from today will help you most?

◆ READ — WHAT HAPPENS IN C8

- ◆ **Part A • Writing (35 minutes, everyone together):** Task 1, reply to a client's email and include every point from your manager's notes (about 25 minutes). Task 2, rewrite three messages so each one is in the right register for its reader (about 10 minutes).
- ◆ **Part B • Speaking (about 7 minutes, in pairs, at your teacher's table):** two short phone calls (you call once and answer once) and a short meeting. You read each card for a few seconds before you start. All names and companies on the cards are fictional.
- ◆ **While you wait:** a quiet reading and ranking task. It is not scored.
- ◆ **Results:** two scores, **Writing /20** and **Speaking /20**, given back privately at the start of C9. It's a check-up, not a final exam.

◆ READ — HOW YOUR WORK IS SCORED (1–5 FOR EACH, TOTAL /20)

Task & Purpose	Did you do what the task asked? Are all the points there, with a clear request or action?
Register & Tone	Is the formality right for the reader or listener? Are you polite and diplomatic, but clear?
Language Range & Accuracy	Do you use a range of useful phrases, with correct grammar and vocabulary?
Organization & Delivery	Is it well organized and easy to follow? In speaking: are you fluent and clear, and do you respond to your partner?

◆ WRITE — BEFORE THE CHECK: RATE YOURSELF (1–5)

	Task & Purpose	Register & Tone	Language Range & Accuracy	Organization & Delivery
Writing				
Speaking				

Three phrases I want to use in the check: _____

◆ WRITE — AFTER THE CHECK (C9)

Copy your two scores and your targets from your score sheet into your **Performance Tracker** (sections 2 and 4).

One sentence from my email that I would now write differently:

Before: _____

After: _____

My journal: which part of the check felt easiest, and which felt hardest? Why?

Presenting, Negotiating & Persuading

Three lessons, three speaking skills. First, **inform**: give a talk that people can follow easily, because you tell them where you are at every step. Then, **trade**: find out what the other side really needs and exchange concessions with "If you..., we'll...". Finally, **persuade**: turn features into benefits, give honest evidence, ask for one clear action and stay calm when someone says "no."

Lessons 3.1-3.3

Classes C9-C11

Level B1+

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Read, Write, Say, Listen** or **With a partner**. Every class ends with a short simulation in a small group: a mini-presentation, a negotiation, a pitch. Nobody has to speak in front of the whole class in this module.

You always choose what to share. For any presentation, negotiation or pitch, you can use your real work, **or** a **role profile** from your teacher (a fictional person, job and company with ready-made facts and figures). Never share confidential information, salaries or the name of a real employer. A role profile is not "less real" practice: the language is exactly the same.

◆ MY MIDPOINT TARGET IN MODULE 3

Your results are a map, not a verdict. First, copy your Writing and Speaking scores (/20) into **section 2** of your Performance Tracker and your targets into **section 4**. Then complete this.

My target (from my score sheet): _____

The criterion it belongs to: _____

Target menu: which Module 3 skill can help?

If my target is about...	...Module 3 can help with	An action I can check
Task & Purpose	a clear call to action (3.1, 3.3); summarizing a deal (3.2)	Every talk and email ends with an action and a date.
Register & Tone	saying no diplomatically (3.2); confident, not pushy (3.3)	I soften every "no": a reason + an alternative.
Language Range & Accuracy	signposts and trend words (3.1); conditionals (3.2)	I use three new phrases per class and check one grammar point.
Organization & Delivery	the shape of a talk and signposting (3.1); pitch stages (3.3)	I plan my structure first and pause after each signpost.

The Module 3 skill that will help me most: _____

One action I will take (something I can check): _____

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY PHRASES

Opening

Good morning, everyone, and thank you for coming.

For those who don't know me, I'm...

Today I'm going to talk about...

The purpose of my talk is to...

By the end, you'll...

I've divided my talk into three parts.

This should take about ten minutes.

Please feel free to ask questions as we go.

I'll take any questions at the end.

Signposting

Let's start with...

Let's move on to...

This brings me to my next point.

Now I'd like to turn to...

As I mentioned earlier...

We'll come to that shortly.

For instance...

A good example of this is...

The key point here is...

What I want to stress is...

So, to sum up...

Let me recap the main points.

Visuals and data

This graph shows...

As you can see from this chart...

If you look at...

I'd like to draw your attention to...

rose steadily / sharply

fell / dropped

peaked at

leveled off

What this tells us is...

The takeaway here is...

Questions and answers

That's a great question.

Just to make sure I understand your question...

I don't have that figure to hand, but I'll follow up.

Let me check and get back to you by tomorrow.

That's a bit outside today's scope.

Can we take that offline?

◆ LANGUAGE BOX

The shape	What it does	What goes in it
Opening	Tell them what you'll tell them.	① greet ② introduce yourself ③ topic + purpose (+ the benefit for them) ④ outline ⑤ housekeeping (questions) + a hook
Body	Tell them.	2–3 main points, with a signpost between each one
Close	Tell them what you told them.	summary · conclusion or call to action · thanks · invite questions

Describing a visual: 4 steps	Example
1 Introduce it	<i>This graph shows</i> our on-time deliveries last year.
2 Direct attention	<i>If you look at</i> the third quarter, ...
3 Describe the trend	...you'll see the figure <i>rose sharply</i> and <i>peaked at</i> 93%.
4 Say what it means	<i>What this tells us is</i> that the new routes work.

Too informal	Too formal / stiff	Just right for most workplaces
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"Hi guys, so, um, it's about invoices."	"I am here today in order to inform you regarding the matter of invoices."	"Good morning, everyone. Today I'm going to talk about invoices."
"Next thing."	"I shall now proceed to the second item."	"This brings me to my next point."
"Dunno, sorry."	"I regret that this information is not available."	"I don't have that figure to hand, but I'll follow up."

Watch out: *rise – rose – risen* (✗ *rised*) · *sales were* (plural) · *talk about reducing* (✗ *talk about to reduce*) · *present to you* (✗ *present you*) · *discuss the results* (✗ *discuss about*).

◆ READ – A MODEL OPENING

Tomás Rivera works in the accounts team at Brightline Foods, a food producer. Read his opening.

- (a) "Good morning, everyone, and thank you for making the time.
- (b) For those who don't know me, I'm Tomás Rivera from the accounts team.
- (c) Here's a question to start with: how long do you think our customers take to pay us? The answer is 52 days.
- (d) Today I'm going to talk about how we can get paid faster. By the end, you'll see two simple changes we can make next month.
- (e) I've divided my talk into three parts: first, why payments are slow; second, the two changes; and finally, what they would cost.
- (f) This should take about ten minutes, and I'll take any questions at the end."

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 1: THE FIVE JOBS

Match each job to a line (a–f) in Tomás's opening.

1. greeting _____
2. introduce yourself _____
3. hook _____
4. topic + purpose + benefit _____
5. outline _____
6. housekeeping _____
7. What kind of hook does Tomás use? _____
8. When can the audience ask questions? _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: PUT THE OPENING IN ORDER

Amira Haddad coordinates operations at Northwind Logistics. Her opening is mixed up. Number the lines 1–6.

- _____ "I've divided my talk into two parts: what changed, and what we should do next."
- _____ "Good afternoon, everyone, and thanks for coming."

_____ "Please feel free to ask questions as we go."

_____ "In January, one delivery in five arrived late. In October, it was one in fourteen."

_____ "I'm Amira Haddad, and I coordinate operations here at Northwind."

_____ "Today I'd like to show you how the new route plan changed our results, and why I think we should use it in every region."

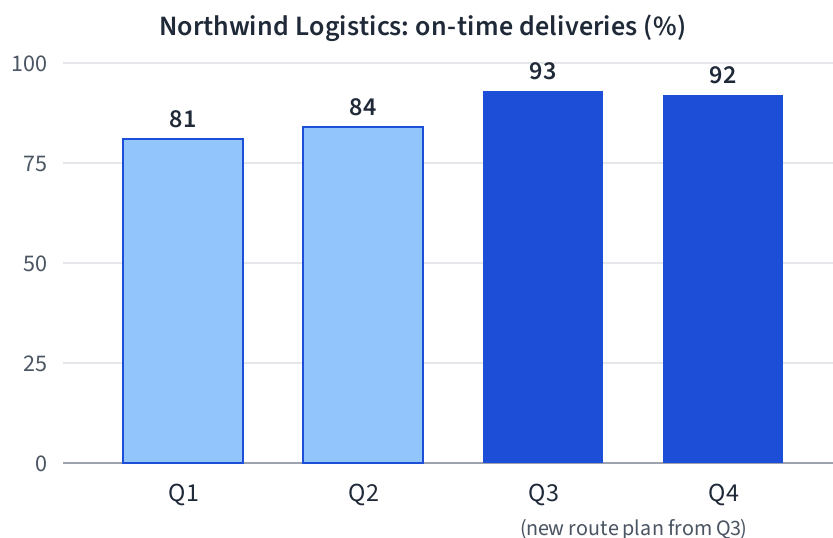
◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: CHOOSE THE SIGNPOST

Circle the best phrase for each situation.

- 1 You have finished your first point and want to start the second.
(a) In conclusion... (b) This brings me to my next point... (c) For instance...
- 2 You want to give a real case to support your point.
(a) For example... (b) As you'll remember... (c) Let me recap...
- 3 You want to go back to a figure from your opening.
(a) We'll come to that shortly. (b) As I mentioned earlier... (c) Last but not least...
- 4 Someone asks about cost, but cost is your third point.
(a) We'll come to that shortly. (b) So much for cost. (c) In conclusion...
- 5 You want to show the most important idea of the talk.
(a) To give you an idea... (b) What I want to stress is... (c) Let's start with...
- 6 You are at the end and want to repeat your main points.
(a) So, to sum up... (b) Now I'd like to turn to... (c) Firstly...

◆ LISTEN AND WRITE – EXERCISE 4: DESCRIBE THE CHART

First, listen to your teacher describe this chart. Raise your hand when you hear a figure that is **wrong**. Then complete Amira's description with the words in the box.



Box: leveled off · What this tells us is · rose sharply · shows · peaked at · If you look at · rose steadily

"This graph (1) _____ our on-time deliveries for last year. (2) _____ the first half of the year, you'll see the figure (3) _____, from 81% to 84%. Then, in Q3, when the new route plan started, it (4) _____ and (5) _____ 93%. In Q4, it (6) _____ at around 92%. (7) _____ that the new route plan works, so we should use it in every region."

◆ WRITE — EXERCISE 5: FROM SLIDE-READING TO SPEAKING

These lines just read the slide. Rewrite each one as something you would **say**: introduce, direct attention, describe, and say what it means.

1. "Slide 4. Customer complaints, 2023 and 2024." (Complaints: 2023 = 240, 2024 = 130.)

2. "Table. Costs: fuel 45%, drivers 35%, repairs 12%, other 8%."

3. "This is a chart of website visits." (Visits: January 3,000 → June 9,000.)

◆ READ AND SAY — DIALOGUE: A QUESTION YOU CAN'T ANSWER

Colleague: Thanks, Amira. How much did the route-planning app cost for the North region?

Amira: That's a great question. Just to make sure I understand: do you mean the monthly fee, or the setup cost as well?

Colleague: Both, really.

Amira: The monthly fee is about four hundred dollars. I don't have the setup cost to hand, but I'll check with finance and follow up by Thursday.

Colleague: Great. And what about the drivers' new contracts?

Amira: That's a bit outside today's scope, I'm afraid. Can we take that offline? I'm happy to talk after the meeting.

Underline the phrase Amira uses to (a) buy time, (b) clarify, (c) promise a follow-up, (d) park a question. Then read it aloud with a partner.

◆ WITH A PARTNER – PRESENTATION CAROUSEL: MY PLANNER

Choose: **my real work** (nothing confidential) ☐ **a role profile** ☐ **a brief card** ☐ My topic:

Opening: Good _____, everyone. I'm _____ from _____. **Hook:** _____ Today I'm going to talk about _____. By the end, you'll _____. I've divided my talk into _____ parts: first, _____; then, _____. Please _____.

Point 1 (Let's start with...): _____ **Example** (For instance...): _____

Signpost: _____ **Point 2:** _____

My visual sentence (introduce → direct → describe → meaning): _____

Close: So, to sum up, _____. My call to action: _____. Thank you. Are there any questions?

Two questions someone might ask me, and my answers:

Presentation checklist: ☐ five jobs in my opening ☐ a signpost at every turn ☐ my visual explained, not just read ☐ eye contact and pauses ☐ summary + call to action ☐ short, honest answers to questions

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

You've finished explaining the problem and want to move the audience to your solution. Which signpost fits best?

A) "That's the problem. This brings me to my solution..."

B) "In conclusion, here's my solution..."

C) "As I mentioned earlier, here's my solution..."

2

Someone asks a detailed question and you don't have the numbers. What's the most professional response?

A) Give a long, general answer and hope it's close enough.

B) "That's not really relevant to my talk."

C) "I don't have that figure to hand, but I'll follow up with you by tomorrow."

3

Which is the best way to present a chart of costs?

A) "This slide shows a table of costs."

B) "As you can see, costs fell sharply in Q2. What this tells us is that the new supplier is saving us money."

C) Read every number on the slide from top to bottom.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ name my Midpoint target and link it to a Module 3 skill
- ◆ ☐ open a presentation with the five jobs and a hook
- ◆ ☐ use a signpost for every move: moving on, examples, going back, emphasis, summing up
- ◆ ☐ describe a chart and say what it means for the audience
- ◆ ☐ answer a question I can't answer, honestly and briefly

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of a presentation or update you might give (real or from a role profile). Which part will you practice most: the opening, signposting, the visual or the Q&A? How?

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY WORDS

a position — what a person says they want ("We need 15% off.")	an interest — why they want it (a budget limit, a deadline, a risk)	a concession — something you give up to move the deal forward	a trade-off — giving one thing to get another
your BATNA / walk-away point — your best plan if there is no deal	a counter-proposal — a new offer after you reject theirs	deadlock — when both sides are stuck and nobody moves	win-win — a deal where both sides get enough to say yes
terms — the details of a deal (price, dates, payment)	to waive a fee — to not charge it	to commit to — to promise to do something (a contract, an order)	to label a concession — to say clearly that it has value ("That's a big step for us.")

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY PHRASES

Opening and exploring

Thanks for making the time. I'm sure we can find something that works for both of us.

Shall we start by agreeing what we'd both like to get out of today?

Our main priority here is...

What's most important to you here?

What's driving that requirement?

Can you help me understand why that matters?

In principle, we'd be open to...

Proposing and accepting

How about we...?

Would you consider...?

What if we were to...?

We'd be prepared to... if...

That works for us.

We can live with that.

That sounds fair. Let's do it.

Rejecting and counter-proposing

I'm afraid that doesn't quite work for us, because...

That's a little more than we can do at the moment.

I understand where you're coming from, but...

What we could offer instead is...

We can't do X, but we could do Y.

Could we meet in the middle at...?

Conceding, deadlock and closing

I can move a little on that, but I'll need something in return.

That's a big concession for us.

Is there any flexibility on...?

Let me take that back to my team.

If price is fixed, could we look at delivery or terms instead?

So, to confirm what we've agreed...

I'll send the details by email this afternoon.

It's been a pleasure doing business with you.

◆ LANGUAGE BOX

Structure	Form	Use it to...	Example
First conditional	If + present simple, ... will / can + verb	make a real offer they can accept now	If you pay within 14 days, we'll waive the setup fee.
Second conditional	If + past simple (or <i>were to</i> + verb), ... would / could + verb	test the water without promising anything	If we paid for shipping, would you sign today? · If you were to double the order, ...
Only if	... provided (that) / as long as + present simple	set a condition	We can hold the price as long as you order this week.
Unless	... unless + present simple (= if not)	say what must change	We can't go lower unless you increase the volume.

✗ If you **will** sign... → ✓ If you **sign**... · The golden rule: **never give something for nothing**. Put an *if* on every concession.

A flat "no" (closes the door)	A diplomatic "no" (reason + a way forward)
"No. That's impossible."	"I'm afraid that doesn't quite work for us, because our margin is very tight. What we could offer instead is free delivery."

"We can't do that date."	"I don't think we can go that far on the date, but we could deliver half the order by then."
"I want you give me discount."	"Is there any flexibility on the price?" / "Could you do a little better on the price?"

◆ READ AND SAY – MODEL DIALOGUE: TWENTY DESKS

Hana Ito is the office manager at Kestrel Design. Rafael Costa sells office furniture for Maple & Stone Furniture.

Rafael: Thanks for making the time, Hana. I'm sure we can find something that works for both of us.

Hana: I hope so. I'll be honest: we need all twenty desks by the 1st, and your quote says the 15th.

Rafael: I see. Can I ask what's driving the 1st?

Hana: Our new team starts on the 1st. Twelve people, and right now they have nowhere to sit.

Rafael: That's really helpful to know. So it's twelve desks that are urgent, not all twenty?

Hana: Exactly. The other eight are for people who join later in the year.

Rafael: Then here's an idea. If you can accept two deliveries, we'll send twelve desks by the 1st and the other eight on the 15th.

Hana: That works. But two deliveries means two delivery charges, doesn't it?

Rafael: Normally, yes. I'm afraid we can't cover both, because our drivers are fully booked that week. What we could offer instead is half price on the second delivery.

Hana: Could you do a little better? Our budget is very tight this quarter.

Rafael: I can move a little, but I'll need something in return. If you pay within 14 days, I'll waive the second charge completely. That's a big step for us, honestly.

Hana: Fourteen days is fine. I think we have a deal.

Rafael: Wonderful. So, to confirm: twelve desks on the 1st, eight on the 15th, no charge for the second delivery, and payment within 14 days. Have I got that right?

Hana: That's everything.

Rafael: Great. I'll send the details by email this afternoon. It's a pleasure working with you.

1. What is Hana's **position**? _____ Her **interest**? _____
2. Which question helps Rafael find her interest? _____
3. Underline the two conditional trades ("If you..., we'll..."). What does Rafael get each time?

4. Find a rejection with a reason and an alternative. _____

5. How does Rafael **label** his concession? _____

6. Mark where each stage starts: open · explore · propose and bargain · close.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 1: NAME THE MOVE

Write **Open**, **Probe**, **Propose**, **Accept**, **Reject**, **Concede** or **Close**.

- 1 "Shall we start by agreeing what we'd both like to get out of today?" _____
- 2 "What would an ideal outcome look like for you?" _____
- 3 "How about we split the delivery into two?" _____
- 4 "That's a little more than we can do at the moment." _____
- 5 "I can move a little on that, but I'll need something in return." _____
- 6 "That sounds fair. Let's do it." _____
- 7 "So, to confirm what we've agreed..." _____
- 8 "Can you help me understand why that date matters?" _____
- 9 "We can live with that." _____
- 10 "I'll draft the contract and get it to you by Friday." _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: DON'T GIVE IT AWAY: TRADE IT

Each line gives something for free. Rewrite it as a trade: ask for something in return.

1. "OK, we'll give you free shipping." _____
2. "Fine, we can start a week earlier." _____
3. "Sure, we'll add two extra training days." _____
4. "All right, you can pay in 60 days." _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: A REAL OFFER OR TESTING THE WATER?

Complete with the correct form of the verbs. Then write **R** (a real offer) or **T** (testing the water).

- 1 If you _____ (commit) to a three-year contract, we _____ (reduce) the price by 5%. [R / T]
- 2 If we _____ (offer) free installation, _____ (you / consider) a larger order? [R / T]
- 3 We _____ (hold) this price as long as you _____ (order) before Friday. [R / T]
- 4 Supposing we _____ (extend) the warranty, _____ (that / help)? [R / T]

- 5 If you _____ (be) to double the order, what discount _____ (you / expect)? [R / T]
- 6 We can't lower the price _____ (if not) you pay a deposit. [R / T]

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: SAY NO WITHOUT CLOSING THE DOOR

Rewrite each flat "no": add a **reason** and a **way forward**.

1. "No. 20% is impossible."

2. "We can't deliver on Saturday."

3. "That price is too high. Forget it."

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: FROM POSITION TO INTEREST

Write a polite question that finds the **why** behind each position.

1. "We need the price down by 10%." _____
2. "The work must be finished by the 30th." _____
3. "We want a one-year contract, not two." _____

◆ WITH A PARTNER – THE DEAL ROOM: MY PLANNER

Your teacher gives you an A or B card. **Don't show it.** Fill this in before you start.

My scenario and role	
My two most important issues	
Issues that matter less to me (I can trade these)	
My ideal deal	

My walk-away point / BATNA	
My question to find their interest	<i>What's most important to you in...?</i>
Trade 1	<i>Example: If you can agree to a longer contract, we can...</i>
Trade 2	
One concession I keep for the end	

Remember: open warmly → ask before you offer → trade, don't give → label your concessions → summarize the deal at the end.

◆ WRITE – A CONFIRMATION EMAIL (HOMEWORK)

Write to the other side after your Deal Room negotiation (80–120 words). Use this frame.

Subject: Confirming our agreement — _____

Hi _____,

Thanks for a productive conversation today. Just to confirm what we agreed:

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

I'll _____ by _____. Please let me know if I've captured anything incorrectly.

_____ (a warm close)

Best regards,

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

The buyer asks for a bigger discount. Which reply is the strongest conditional trade?

A) "OK, fine, we'll take another 5% off."

B) "We could do another 5% if you commit to a two-year contract."

C) "No, that's the price. Take it or leave it."

2

You've agreed all the terms. What's the best way to close?

A) Shake hands and leave. You both know what was said.

B) Ask for one more concession now that they've agreed.

C) Summarize what you've agreed, confirm it, and say you'll send the details by email.

3

"If you signed today, would you expect a discount?" What is the speaker doing?

A) Making a firm offer the buyer can accept now.

B) Testing the water: finding out what the buyer wants without promising anything.

C) Rejecting the buyer's proposal.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ explain the difference between a position and an interest
- ◆ ☐ ask a question to find out what the other side really needs
- ◆ ☐ make a real offer and test the water with conditionals
- ◆ ☐ say no politely, with a reason and an alternative
- ◆ ☐ trade concessions and label them
- ◆ ☐ summarize a deal aloud and confirm it by email

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of a negotiation you might have (a deadline, a workload, a purchase; real or invented). What could the other side's interest be? Write one "If you..., we'll..." trade you could offer.

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY WORDS

a pitch — a short talk to get someone to say yes to an idea, product or request	a hook — an opening that makes the listener want to hear more	a pain point — a problem the listener really feels	a feature — what something is or has ("It works offline.")
a benefit — what it does for the listener ("You never lose your work.")	evidence / social proof — results, figures or other users that show it works	a call to action — the one clear next step you ask for	an objection — a reason the listener gives for not saying yes (yet)
a pilot / a trial — a small, short test before a full decision	ROI (return on investment) — what you get back compared with what you pay	an elevator pitch — a 30–60 second version of your pitch	to overpromise — to promise more than you can deliver

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY PHRASES

Value (make the benefit clear)

This will save you time / money.

It cuts the process from days to hours.

It reduces the risk of errors.

The key benefit for you is...

What this means for your team is...

...which means that...

...so that...

Credibility (make it believable)

In our pilot, the team cut costs by around...

Clients have seen a 30% increase in...

On average, users report...

Teams like yours already use it to...

Here's the data behind that.

Confident framing and the ask

You know how...?

Imagine your team no longer having to...

You'll be able to...

I'm confident this will work for you because...

Could we run a two-week trial?

Would you be open to...?

I'd love your go-ahead to...

Handling objections (LAARC)

That's a fair concern.

I completely understand why you'd ask that.

Can I ask what's driving that?

Just so I understand: is it the price, or the timing?

Let me put that in context.

That's exactly why we offer a trial.

Would it help if I showed you the numbers?

Does that address your concern?

◆ LANGUAGE BOX

Feature (what it is / has)	Bridge	Benefit (what it does for you)
The report runs automatically every Monday	...so that...	you start the week already knowing where you stand.
It works with your existing tools	...which means that...	nobody has to learn a new system.
Setup takes two minutes	...so that...	you see results today, not next month.

The pitch: 5 stages	Sounds like...
1 Hook / problem	"You know how our team spends every Friday afternoon on timesheets?"
2 Solution	"I'd like to introduce a simple app that fills them in from our calendars."
3 Benefit	"So everyone gets their Friday afternoon back."
4 Evidence	"The design team tried it for a month and saved about two hours each."
5 Call to action	"Could we try it with our team for four weeks?"

Pushy or over-hyped	Confident and honest
"It's the best product in the world."	"In our pilot, it cut processing time by around a third."
"You must decide today!"	"The sooner we start, the sooner you see the savings."
"You're wrong, it's not expensive."	"That's a fair concern. Let me put the cost in context."

Watch out: ✗ *It permits to save time* → ✓ *It lets you / helps you save time* · ✗ *Let me explain you* → ✓ *Let me explain* · ✗ *very unique, more cheaper* → ✓ *unique, cheaper*.

◆ READ – A MODEL PITCH

Amira Haddad pitches an idea to her regional director at Northwind Logistics.

- (1) "You know how our drivers lose time every morning working out the best route?"
- (2) I'd like to propose a route-planning app that plans every driver's day automatically.
- (3) That means drivers spend their time driving, not planning, and customers get their deliveries on time.
- (4) When we tested it in the North region last quarter, on-time deliveries rose from 84% to 93%.
- (5) Could we try it in two more regions for one month and review the numbers together?"

Write the stage next to each number: hook/problem · solution · benefit · evidence · call to action.

(1) _____ (2) _____ (3) _____ (4) _____ (5) _____

Why is the call to action easy to say yes to? _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 1: FEATURE OR BENEFIT?

Write **F** (feature) or **B** (benefit).

- 1 The software has 40 report templates. _____
- 2 You can prepare a report for your manager in five minutes. _____
- 3 The chairs are fully adjustable. _____
- 4 Your staff go home without back pain. _____
- 5 The service is available in 12 languages. _____
- 6 Your customers can get help in their own language. _____
- 7 The new laptop is 30% lighter than the old model. _____
- 8 Your engineers carry less on long site visits. _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: BUILD THE BRIDGE

Add ...*which means that*... or ...*so that*... and a real benefit for the listener.

1. "The booking calendar sends automatic reminders..." _____
2. "Our lunch boxes stay fresh for five days..." _____
3. "The venue is two minutes from the train station..." _____
4. "The chat assistant answers the 20 most common questions..." _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: ORDER THE PITCH AND ADD THE ASK

Kwame Mensah works in HR at Silverleaf Clinics. Put his pitch in order (1–4), then write a call to action.

- _____ (a) "In a two-month trial at our Eastside clinic, phone waiting times fell from 9 minutes to 4."
_____ (b) "You know how patients get frustrated waiting on the phone to book an appointment?"
_____ (c) "So patients book in seconds, and reception staff have more time for people at the desk."
_____ (d) "We'd like to introduce online booking through the clinic website."

My call to action: _____

◆ WRITE — EXERCISE 4: ANSWER THE OBJECTION

A. Match each objection to the best strategy: *reframe to value* · *show what's different* · *the cost of waiting* · *find the real concern*.

1. "It's too expensive." _____
2. "We already have a supplier for that." _____
3. "Now's not a good time." _____
4. "I need to think about it." _____

B. For objections 1 and 4, write what you would say first: **acknowledge + ask**.

1. _____
4. _____

◆ WRITE — EXERCISE 5: CONFIDENT, NOT OVER-HYPED

Rewrite each claim so it is honest, specific and still persuasive.

1. "This is the best app in the world and it will double your profits, guaranteed."

2. "Everybody is using it. You'll be left behind if you don't buy today."

3. "It never breaks. Ever."

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: "WE ALREADY USE SPREADSHEETS"

Client: It looks nice, but we already use spreadsheets for expenses. They work fine.

Seller: That's a fair point. Spreadsheets are flexible. Can I ask what you like most about them?

Client: Everyone knows how to use them. And, honestly, all our data from the last five years is in them.

Seller: Just so I understand: is the main worry learning a new tool, or losing your old data?

Client: The data. I can't lose five years of records.

Seller: I completely understand. We import all your old spreadsheets for you, free of charge, and you can check everything before you switch. Would it help if we tested it with last month's expenses first?

Client: Yes, that would help.

Seller: Great. Does that address your concern?

Client: It does. Let's try it with last month's data.

Find the five LAARC steps: Listen · Acknowledge · Ask · Respond · Confirm. What was the client's real concern? _____

◆ WITH A PARTNER – PITCH & PUSH-BACK: MY PLANNER

Choose: a **pitch card** ☐ **my role profile** ☐ **my own idea** (nothing confidential) ☐ I'm pitching:

1 Hook / problem	You know how _____?
2 Solution	I'd like to introduce / We've built _____
3 Benefit	It _____, which means that _____
4 Evidence	In our pilot / trial, _____
5 Call to action	Could we _____?

Two objections I expect, and my first line for each (acknowledge + ask):

My 30-second elevator pitch (who I am · what I do / offer · the value · the ask):

◆ SAY — SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which of these is a benefit, not a feature?

A) It has a 500-page paper capacity.

B) So you can print all day without stopping to reload paper.

C) It's built with a two-tray design.

2

A client says "It's too expensive." What's the best first move?

A) "That's a fair concern. Can I ask what's driving that: the total or the monthly cost?"

B) "It's actually very reasonable. You're wrong about that."

C) "OK, I'll take 30% off right now."

3

Which claim is honest and persuasive?

A) "This is guaranteed to double your sales."

B) "In our three-month pilot, the team cut admin time by around 30%."

C) "Everyone in the industry is using it."

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ structure a pitch: problem → solution → benefit → evidence → call to action
- ◆ ☐ turn a feature into a benefit with "which means that..."
- ◆ ☐ give evidence honestly, without over-hyping
- ◆ ☐ acknowledge an objection and ask a question before I answer it
- ◆ ☐ give a 30-second elevator pitch with a clear ask

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of an idea you would like someone to say yes to (real or from a role profile). Which objection do you fear most, and what will you say first when you hear it?

MODULE 3 — LOOKING BACK

Look at your Midpoint target on the first page of this module. Which lesson in Module 3 helped most with it? Write one sentence: _____

Business Writing & Career

Three lessons and the Final Assessment. Write reports and proposals that a busy reader can act on. Present your experience with a strong CV, a targeted cover letter and clear interview answers. Then bring the whole course together: adapt to different workplace cultures, rehearse a complete client project, and prepare your capstone presentation.

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C12–C16

Level B1+

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Write**, **Listen**, **Say**, **Read** or **With a partner**. In business writing and speaking there is often more than one good answer. What matters is that your message is **clear**, has the **right tone** and gets the **result you want**.

When a task asks about your own work history, you decide what to share. Use your real experience, **or** a **role card** (a fictional person with a fictional job and company), **or** a mix. You never need to name a real employer or share your salary or any private information. You're practicing the English, not handing in your life story.

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY VOCABULARY

a report

presents findings:
what happened, what
the data shows

a proposal

persuades someone to
approve a plan

**an executive
summary**

a short summary at
the start, for busy
readers

findings

what you discovered
from the evidence

conclusions

what the findings
mean

recommendations

the actions you advise

an appendix (plural:
appendices)
extra detail at the end

scope

what the document
covers (and doesn't)

objective (adj.)

based on facts, not
feelings

to hedge

to make a claim more
careful: *This
suggests...*

to prioritize

to put things in order
of importance

a call to action

the clear thing you ask
the reader to do

The aim of this report is to...

This proposal sets out...

The results show that...

It was found that...

Notably, ...

As shown in Figure 1, ...

See Appendix A for full details.

These findings suggest that...

On balance, ...

We recommend that...

It is recommended that the team be expanded.

In the short term, ...; in the longer term, ...

◆ LANGUAGE BOX

Report or proposal?

	Report	Proposal
Core question	What happened? What does the evidence show?	What should we do next, and why?
Time	past and present	future
Main job	inform (and sometimes advise)	persuade and win approval
Typical request	"Give me the findings."	"Convince me to fund this."

Email register → document register. Documents are more formal and objective than most emails. Clear is better than impressive.

Email style (often)	Document style
I think we lost customers because...	The data indicates that customer loss was driven by...
We found out that...	It was found that... / The analysis shows that...
I'm pretty sure this means...	This suggests that... / It appears that...
You should hire more people.	We recommend hiring two more agents. / It is recommended that the team be expanded.
contractions, <i>I / you</i> , chatty words	full forms, impersonal phrases, neutral tone

Making recommendations.

recommend + -ing	We recommend hiring two agents by the end of Q3.
recommend / propose that + base form	It is recommended that the contract be renewed . · We propose that the deadline be moved to June 30.
should = firm	We should prioritize the billing fix.
could = an option	The team could also consider a weekend shift.
priority	As a priority, ... · In the short term, ...; in the longer term, ...

An approvable recommendation is: Specific · Actionable (who, what, by when) · Prioritized · Cost/benefit-aware · Tied to the findings.

◆ READ – MODEL: AN EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

NORTHWIND LOGISTICS · OPERATIONS TEAM · APRIL 12

Late Deliveries in the Northern Region, January–March

Executive Summary

This report examines the causes of late deliveries in the Northern Region in the first quarter and recommends a response. Late deliveries rose from 6% to 14% of all orders. It was found that two causes account for most of the delay: routes are still planned by hand, and one of the three vans was out of service for five weeks. Notably, 70% of late orders were on Monday and Tuesday routes. We recommend three actions: (1) introduce the route-planning software already used in the Southern Region by the end of May; (2) lease a replacement van for the busy early-week routes; and (3) review driver schedules in the third quarter. Together, these steps are expected to bring late deliveries back below 6% by July.

Mark the purpose **P**, the key findings **F** and the recommendations **R**. Then answer:

1. If the director reads only this, what can she approve? _____
2. Which word introduces the most striking finding? _____
3. Find one passive structure. _____
4. Why are the recommendations numbered? _____

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: THE FINDINGS BRIEFING

Your teacher reads a short meeting at Brightline Foods. Grace (Head of Customer Experience) asks Tomás (Online Orders team lead) about customer complaints. Is it a report or a proposal? Then listen again and complete the notes.

Customers in the survey	1 _____
Complaints per quarter	120 → 2 _____
About damaged packaging	3 _____ %
About late delivery	4 _____ %
Eastfield trial: damage cut by	5 _____
Extra cost of the new boxes	6 _____ per box

Write one finding sentence with a phrase from the bank: _____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 2: ORDER THE SECTIONS

A. Put the sections of a **report** in the standard order (1–7).

a) Recommendations _____ · b) Executive Summary _____ · c) Findings _____ · d) Introduction _____ · e) Conclusions _____ · f) Appendices _____ · g) Title _____

B. Put the sections of a **proposal** in the standard order (1–7).

a) Benefits _____ · b) Risks _____ · c) Background / Problem _____ · d) Recommendation / Call to action _____ · e) Objectives _____ · f) Proposed plan _____ · g) Costs, resources & timeline _____

You write the executive summary _____ (first / last), but it goes _____ (first / last) in the document.

◆ READ – EXERCISE 3: WHAT DOES THE PHRASE DO?

Write the function: **Purpose**, **Findings**, **Data**, **Conclusion** or **Recommend**.

1. "It is recommended that the process be automated." _____
2. "The aim of this report is to evaluate supplier performance." _____

3. "The data indicates a 20% drop in returns." _____
4. "As shown in Figure 2, costs peaked in March." _____
5. "On balance, the evidence points to a staffing problem." _____
6. "The best course of action would be to renegotiate the contract." _____
7. "Notably, satisfaction rose fastest among new customers." _____
8. "Full figures are provided in Appendix B." _____
9. "This proposal sets out a plan to reduce delivery times." _____
10. "These findings suggest that the problem is seasonal." _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: REWRITE FOR A REPORT

Rewrite each sentence in formal, objective document style. Keep it clear: no jargon.

1. "I think we lost customers because our prices went up."
→ _____
2. "We found out that most complaints are about packaging."
→ _____
3. "I'm pretty sure this means the problem is getting worse."
→ _____
4. "You should hire more people."
→ _____
5. "Basically, the new supplier's boxes are way better."
→ _____
6. "In order to facilitate the operationalization of enhanced efficiencies going forward, the utilization of the new system should perhaps be leveraged."
→ _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: FROM VAGUE TO APPROVABLE

A. Use the facts to turn each vague recommendation into an approvable one (specific, actionable, tied to the facts).

1. "We should do something about late deliveries." (*Facts: late deliveries 14%; 70% on Monday and Tuesday routes; the Southern Region's software cut late deliveries to 4%.*)
→ _____
2. "Marketing needs more money." (*Facts: email campaigns returned \$6 for every \$1 spent; social media ads returned \$1.50 for every \$1.*)
→ _____

3. "Staff should be trained better." (Facts: 40% of order errors are made by staff in their first three months.)

→ _____

B. Complete with the correct form, *should* or *could*.

1. It is recommended that the contract _____ (renew) for two years.

2. We propose that the deadline _____ (move) to June 30.

3. We _____ prioritize the billing fix: it causes 60% of calls. (firm)

4. The team _____ also consider a weekend shift. (an option)

5. We recommend _____ (hire) one more agent by the end of Q3.

◆ WRITE – YOUR EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (80–120 WORDS)

Choose one: your **proposal brief card**, the Brightline notes from Exercise 1, or a topic from your work (change any names and numbers that are confidential). Write the summary **last**, but it goes **first**.

Title: _____

Purpose: This report examines / This proposal sets out _____

Key findings: Currently, _____ Notably, _____

Recommendations: We recommend (1) _____ (2) _____ (3)

Expected result: Together, these steps are expected to _____

◆ WITH A PARTNER – THE DECISION-MAKER

Give your summary to your partner. They are the decision-maker: they read it for **60 seconds only**, ask two questions from their card, and then decide: **approve**, **approve with changes** or **not yet**, with one reason. Then swap.

Could you clarify...?

How sure are these figures?

I'm happy to approve this on one condition...

I'd need to see... before I can approve it.

Let's start with phase one.

Checklist for your partner's summary	✓
Task & Purpose: purpose, findings and recommendations are all there; the ask is clear	
Register & Tone: objective, no chatty words, no jargon; polite answers	
Language Range & Accuracy: document phrases; <i>recommend</i> + -ing or <i>that... be</i> ; numbers correct	

Organization & Delivery: purpose → findings → recommendations; recommendations numbered; clear, calm answers

My partner's decision: _____ · Their reason: _____ · One thing I'd change: _____

◆ SAY — SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which best describes a good executive summary?

- A) A short, standalone recap of purpose, key findings and recommendations: written last, placed first.
- B) A teaser that lists what the report will discuss, saving the conclusions for the end.
- C) A section that only makes sense after reading the whole document.

2

Which recommendation is most likely to get approved?

- A) The company should improve customer support somehow.
- B) We must leverage synergies to operationalize a best-in-class support paradigm going forward.
- C) We recommend hiring two agents by the end of Q3 to bring wait times below five minutes (see Appendix A).

3

Which sentence is in formal, objective document style?

- A) I'm pretty sure customers left because of the prices.
- B) The data indicates that customer loss was driven mainly by price increases.
- C) Customers left, basically because stuff got too expensive.

4

Your manager says, "Convince me to fund the new training program." What are you writing?

A) A report

B) A proposal

C) A meeting agenda

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ say whether a task needs a report or a proposal, and choose the right structure
- ◆ ☐ write a short, standalone executive summary: purpose + key findings + recommendations
- ◆ ☐ rewrite chatty or jargon-heavy sentences in clear, formal document style
- ◆ ☐ write specific, actionable, prioritized recommendations tied to the findings
- ◆ ☐ answer a decision-maker's questions about my proposal politely and clearly

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of a document or long email you wrote or received that didn't get the result it wanted. What was the problem (a weak summary, too much jargon, a vague recommendation)? What will you do differently next time?

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY VOCABULARY

a CV / a résumé

a 1–2 page summary
of your experience
(résumé in the US and
Canada)

**a professional
summary**

2–3 lines at the top of
your CV

a duty

a task that was part of
your job

an achievement

a result you produced

an action verb

*led, reduced, trained,
delivered...*

to quantify

to add a number, a %, a
time or a scale

a cover letter

a one-page letter sent
with your CV

a job advert / posting

the description of the
job

a behavioral question

"Tell me about a time
when you..."

**a career break / a
gap**

a time between jobs

credentials

your qualifications
(degrees, licenses)

transferable skills

skills you can use in a
new kind of job

I am writing to apply for the position of...

In my current role at..., I have...

This directly matches your requirement for...

I am particularly drawn to your company because...

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss...

In my last role, we were...

I was responsible for...

So I decided to...

As a result, ...

What does success look like in this role in the first six months?

What are the next steps in the process?

Thank you for your time today.

◆ LANGUAGE BOX

Duty → achievement. Action verb + what you did + a measurable result.

Duty (weak)	Achievement (strong)
Responsible for sales in my region.	Grew regional sales 20% in 12 months.
Was in charge of a team.	Managed a team of 8, cutting delivery time by 15%.
Helped with customer complaints.	Resolved 40+ customer issues a week, lifting satisfaction from 78% to 91%.

No exact number? Estimate honestly, or use scale (*a team of 6*), frequency (*weekly*), time saved (*about 6 hours a month*) or before → after (*78% to 91%*).

STAR: tell a clear story.

S — Situation	where, when, the context (short)	In my last role, a client moved its launch forward by two weeks.
T — Task	your responsibility or challenge	As the coordinator, I had to...
A — Action	what you did (the longest part; say "I")	So I split the work into daily targets and...
R — Result	the outcome, with a number if possible	As a result, we delivered a day early, and the client has since...

Your path: short, true and positive. You decide what to share. One or two sentences, then move back to what you offer.

A career break	From 2021 to 2023, I took a career break for family reasons. During that time, I completed a certificate in... I'm now ready to return to full-time work.
A qualification from another country	I hold a degree in civil engineering from a university in my home country. It has been assessed as equivalent to a U.S. bachelor's degree. / I'm currently completing the local licensing process.
A career change	After six years in graphic design, I'm moving into UX design. My transferable skills include... and I've recently completed...
A new start	I'm building my career here, and I'm keen to bring my experience in... to a role where I can learn local systems quickly.

◆ READ — MODEL: A CV EXTRACT

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Operations coordinator with seven years' experience in food distribution, including four years supervising warehouse teams. Skilled in route planning, stock control and staff training. Looking to bring a record of fewer errors and faster deliveries to a growing logistics team.

EXPERIENCE

Operations Assistant, Brightline Foods • 2023–present

- Reduced picking errors by 18% by introducing a two-step check at dispatch.
- Responsible for the weekly stock report.
- Trained 9 new warehouse staff, all of whom passed their safety assessment the first time.

Career break • 2021–2023 • Family responsibilities • Completed an online certificate in Supply Chain Management (120 hours).

Warehouse Supervisor, a food distributor (overseas) • 2016–2021

- Managed a team of 12 across two shifts, cutting overtime costs by 15%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Industrial Engineering, 2016 (credential evaluation: equivalent to a U.S. bachelor's degree)

1. Find the one duty bullet. Rewrite it as an achievement (invent a plausible result):

2. How does the CV show the career break? Is it positive? _____

3. How does it show the degree from another country? _____

4. Which three keywords would a job advert for a logistics coordinator probably contain?

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: TWO ANSWERS, ONE QUESTION

The interviewer asks: "Tell me about a time you had to meet a tight deadline." Your teacher reads two answers, from Rafael and Joy. Who would you hire? Then listen to Joy again and write the first words of each part.

S	
T	
A	
R	

Two reasons why Rafael's answer is weaker: _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: DUTY → ACHIEVEMENT

Rewrite each duty as an achievement bullet. Start with an action verb and use the facts.

1. "Responsible for answering customer emails." (*about 50 a day; 95% answered the same day*)
→ _____
2. "Helped organize company events." (*4 events a year; up to 120 guests; all on budget*)
→ _____
3. "In charge of updating the website." (*traffic up 25% in six months*)
→ _____
4. "Did the monthly reports." (*automated two spreadsheets; saved the team about 6 hours a month*)
→ _____
5. "Was in charge of new staff." (*trained 12 new hires; errors in their first three months down 30%*)
→ _____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 3: THE FOUR PARTS OF A COVER LETTER

Write the part for each sentence: **Opening**, **Why you**, **Why them** or **Closing**.

- a) "I am writing to apply for the position of Operations Coordinator, as advertised on your careers page."

- b) "In my current role, I reduced delivery errors by 22% by introducing a double-check at dispatch."

- c) "I admire Northwind's recent move to electric delivery vans in the city center." _____
- d) "I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I could contribute to your team." _____
- e) "This directly matches your requirement for someone who can improve process accuracy." _____
- f) "I was excited to see your opening for a coordinator with warehouse experience." _____
- g) "I am particularly drawn to your company because of its focus on staff training." _____
- h) "I am available for interview at your convenience and look forward to hearing from you." _____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 4: ORDER THE STAR ANSWER

The question is "Tell me about a time you showed leadership." Put the sentences in order.

- a) I split the report into clear sections and gave each one to the right person.
- b) Our team was falling behind on an important quarterly report.
- c) We delivered it on time, and our manager praised how smoothly the team had worked.
- d) Then, halfway through, our manager was off sick for two weeks.
- e) Someone needed to keep it on track, so I volunteered to coordinate it.
- f) I also set up two short check-ins a week so we could catch problems early.

Order: _____ → _____ → _____ → _____ → _____ → _____

Now plan your own STAR answer to "Tell me about a time you solved a problem." Use your own experience or a role card.

S • In my last role, ...	
T • I was responsible for... / I had to...	
A • So I...	
R • As a result, ...	

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: FIX THE WEAK LINE

What's the problem? Rewrite each one.

1. Cover letter: "I am a hard-working team player and would be a great fit for any role at your company."

Problem: _____

→ _____

2. Interview: a candidate talks about their last job: "My boss was terrible and the company was a mess."

Problem: _____

→ _____

3. Interview, "What's your greatest weakness?": "I'm a perfectionist. I just work too hard."

Problem: _____

→ _____

4. STAR Action: "We had a meeting and we fixed it."

Problem: _____

→ _____

5. End of interview, "Do you have any questions for us?": "No, I think you covered everything."

Problem: _____

→ _____

◆ WRITE – YOUR PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY AND THREE BULLETS

For yourself, a role card, or a mix. Choose one job advert and use its keywords.

The job I'm applying for: _____

Summary (who you are + key strengths + what you offer):

Bullet 1: _____

Bullet 2: _____

Bullet 3: _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: THE END OF AN INTERVIEW

Interviewer: Thank you, Chris. That's all from me. Do you have any questions for us?

Chris: Yes, thank you. What does success look like in this role in the first six months?

Interviewer: Good question. Mainly getting the new scheduling system running and bringing average wait times down.

Chris: That's exactly the kind of project I enjoy. And what are the next steps in the process?

Interviewer: We're seeing two more candidates this week, and we'll be in touch by Friday.

Chris: Great. Thank you for taking the time to meet me today. I really enjoyed learning more about the team.

Underline Chris's two questions. What does Chris do after the interviewer's first answer? Why is that a good idea?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – MOCK INTERVIEW TRIOS

Work in threes: **candidate**, **interviewer** (uses the interviewer card and a job advert) and **observer** (keeps time and fills the checklist). Change roles each round. Candidates: real history, a role card, or a mix.

Open	"Thank you for coming in. Please have a seat."
Question 1	Tell me about yourself. (under 1 minute: present → past → future)
Question 2	a STAR question from the card
Question 3	one more question from the card
Close	"Do you have any questions for us?" → "Thank you, we'll be in touch."
Feedback	the observer gives one strength and one next step, with a quote

When I was the candidate: my strongest answer was _____ · one next step: _____

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which is the strongest CV bullet point?

A) Responsible for the sales team and its targets.

B) Led an 8-person sales team to exceed target by 18% in a year.

C) Hard-working salesperson who is great with people.

2

In the STAR method, what should the Action step focus on?

- A) The specific steps you personally took.
- B) A detailed background of the whole company situation.
- C) The final outcome and what you learned.

3

A candidate mentions their last job in an interview. Which sentence is best?

- A) "My boss was terrible."
- B) "I'd achieved what I could there, and I was looking for a bigger challenge, which is what drew me to this role."
- C) "I'd rather not say."

4

Your CV shows a two-year gap. What's the best approach?

- A) Change the dates so nobody notices.
- B) Explain it briefly and positively, and mention anything you did or learned during that time.
- C) Give a long, detailed explanation of your private life.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ rewrite a duty as an achievement: action verb + what + result
- ◆ ☐ write a short professional summary without empty adjectives
- ◆ ☐ name the four parts of a targeted cover letter and use its phrases
- ◆ ☐ answer a "Tell me about a time..." question with STAR
- ◆ ☐ talk about a career gap, a career change or a qualification from another country in a short, positive way (if I choose to)
- ◆ ☐ ask two good questions at the end of an interview and close politely

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

Five action verbs I'll use on my CV.

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one "Responsible for..." line from your CV (or a role card) as an achievement. Then write the title of one STAR story you'll keep ready for your next interview.

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY VOCABULARY

cross-cultural

between people with different norms

directness

how openly people say what they mean

hierarchy

how much seniority and titles matter

consensus

a decision the whole group agrees on

high-context

meaning is often implied, not said

low-context

meaning is said clearly and written down

rapport

a good, trusting relationship

to mirror

to match someone's style and pace

a soft signal

a polite hint, e.g. a gentle "no"

a tendency

what is common, not what is always true

a capstone

a final project that shows everything you learned

an action plan

concrete steps with dates

Thank you for making the time.

It's a real pleasure to be working with you.

May I call you [first name]?

Just to make sure I've understood, ...

How would you prefer we handle this?

Would it help if I put this in writing?

There's no need to decide today.

Please take the time you need.

I sense this may be difficult — shall we look at another option?

I want to make sure this works for both sides.

◆ READ — MY TOOLKIT

Rate yourself from 1 (not yet) to 5 (confident). Circle your two strongest and your two weakest areas.

Area	1–5	Area	1–5
Register & tone (1.1)		Presentations (3.1)	
Emails & messages (1.2)		Negotiating (3.2)	
Phone & video calls (1.3)		Pitching & persuading (3.3)	
Meetings (2.1)		Reports & proposals (4.1)	
Small talk & networking (2.2)		CVs & interviews (4.2)	

Diplomacy & assertiveness (2.3)		Cross-cultural awareness (4.3)	
---------------------------------	--	--------------------------------	--

◆ LANGUAGE BOX

What varies between workplaces. These are **tendencies**. People vary inside every country, and every company has its own culture too.

Directness	say it plainly ↔ imply it politely	With indirect communicators, soften more and listen for hints.
Formality & hierarchy	first names early ↔ titles and seniority	Start formal: <i>Ms. / Mr. + surname</i> until invited.
Relationship vs task	agenda first ↔ trust first	Where rapport comes first, make time for small talk.
Time	fixed start and agenda ↔ flexible	Be on time yourself; confirm deadlines clearly.
Disagreement	open, in the room ↔ quiet, private, hints	Criticize gently; notice "That could be difficult."
Decision-making	one leader, fast ↔ the group, slower	Don't push for an instant yes; give time.
Context	low: say it and write it ↔ high: tone and relationship carry meaning	Listen for what isn't said; confirm in writing.

Golden rules that work anywhere: observe and mirror · start more formal · avoid idioms and slang · confirm in writing · different doesn't mean wrong · when unsure, ask.

The conditional trade: *If you can + verb, we could + verb.* → *If you can commit to a two-year agreement, we could offer a 10% reduction.*

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: FIRST CALL, TWO VERSIONS

Sam from Kestrel Design has a first call with Ms. Laura Quinn from Harborview Retail. Harborview's team prefers a formal style, builds relationships first and decides by consensus. Listen to version 1 and write three problems. Then listen to version 2 and write three fixes.

Version 1: problems	Version 2: fixes
1	1
2	2
3	3

Ms. Quinn says, "That may be somewhat difficult on our side today." What does she probably mean?

◆ READ – EXERCISE 2: READ THE SOFT SIGNAL

What might each line mean? Choose a good response from the phrase bank. (In some teams these words are meant literally. When you're not sure, ask.)

1. "That may be somewhat difficult for us."

It might mean: _____ · Response: _____

2. "We'll need to discuss it internally."

It might mean: _____ · Response: _____

3. "Interesting idea. We'll think about it."

It might mean: _____ · Response: _____

4. "Hmm... Friday is a little tight."

It might mean: _____ · Response: _____

5. (A long silence after you give the price.)

It might mean: _____ · Response: _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: FIX THE OPENER AND THE EMAIL

Rewrite for a new partner whose team is formal, relationship-first and decides by consensus.

1. Meeting opener: "Hey folks — let's skip the small talk and get straight to it. I need a yes today."

→ _____

2. Email: "Hi Laura, need your decision on the price by end of day. Thx."

→ _____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 4: WHICH SKILL DO YOU NEED?

Match each situation (1–6) to the skill (a–f).

1 A colleague's plan has a flaw, and you must say so without offending them. _____	a) Small talk & networking
2 A senior manager reads only the first line of your email. _____	b) Negotiation: a conditional trade
3 The client wants a lower price than you can give. _____	c) Interviews: STAR
4 You arrive early for a meeting with a new partner. _____	d) Diplomacy & assertiveness
5 Two people keep talking over each other in a meeting you are chairing. _____	e) Emails & reports: the ask up front

6 A recruiter asks, "Tell me about a time you..." _____

f) Meetings: chairing and turn-taking

◆ READ – EXERCISE 5: ORDER THE FOLLOW-UP EMAIL

After the kick-off meeting, Sam writes to Ms. Quinn. Put the parts in order (1–7).

- a) Please let me know if I've missed anything or if you'd like any changes. I look forward to your thoughts.

- b) Dear Ms. Quinn, _____
- c) • We'll proceed with a phased approach and a dedicated point of contact. • We'll send a draft project plan by Friday for your team's review. • On pricing, we've proposed a 10% reduction in exchange for a two-year agreement, for your team to consider. _____
- d) Subject: Summary and next steps — Kestrel Design and Harborview kick-off _____
- e) Kind regards, Sam Ortiz, Kestrel Design _____
- f) To confirm what we discussed: _____
- g) Thank you again for a productive meeting today. It was a pleasure to meet your team. _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: THE NEGOTIATION

Ms. Quinn: Before we go further, we would need the price reduced by 15%.

Sam: I completely understand that budget is important, and I want to make this work for both of us. A 15% reduction on the current scope would be difficult for us. However, if your team can commit to a two-year agreement, we could offer a 10% reduction and hold that rate. Would that be a helpful direction to explore?

Ms. Quinn: That could work. Let us discuss it internally.

Sam: Of course. Please take the time you need. I'll put the proposal in writing so your team has everything to consider.

Underline: the acknowledgment · the conditional trade · the question that invites a reply · the offer to confirm in writing.

◆ WITH A PARTNER – THE CLIENT SCENARIO (TRIOS)

Work in threes: **Kestrel lead**, **Harborview contact** and **observer**. One stage per round; change roles each round.

Round 1 · Meeting	Welcome, brief small talk, a light agenda, invite the client to start.
Round 2 · Pitch	One feature → its benefit for Harborview → a consensus-friendly call to action.

Round 3 · Negotiation	The client asks for 15%. Acknowledge, trade conditionally, give space, offer to confirm in writing.
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One phrase I used well: _____ · One thing to change: _____

◆ **WRITE – MY CAPSTONE PLANNER (FOR C16)**

Your pitch is **5 minutes**, then questions (in a pair pitch, each of you speaks for at least 2 minutes). Use the Capstone Pitch Brief your teacher gives you. Topic: your own idea (real or role card), the Review Project approach, or Brief 1, 2 or 3. Keywords, not full sentences.

My topic	
My audience (who decides?)	
1 Opening: greet · topic · hook · what's in it for them · outline	
2 Problem (+ one number)	
3 Solution (1–2 sentences)	
4 Benefits: "...which means that..."	
5 Evidence: a result, a pilot, a comparison	
6 Close: "So, to sum up..." + my call to action	
Two objections I expect + my answers	
My two STAR stories (titles) for the interview	

This brings me to...

Let's move on to...

That's a good question.

If I understand correctly, you're asking...

I understand the concern. In fact, ...

I don't have that figure with me, but I'll send it by Friday.

What I'm asking you to approve today is...

◆ **SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C**

1

You're on a first call with a partner whose team is formal, consensus-driven and relationship-first. Which approach fits best?

- A) Use first names, skip the small talk, and ask for a decision by the end of the call.
- B) Open warmly and formally, make some small talk, and offer to send a written summary so their team can decide together.
- C) Keep it casual with plenty of idioms so it feels friendly.

2

A client asks for a bigger discount than you can offer. Which move fits best?

- A) Simply refuse and repeat the original price.
- B) Immediately agree to the full discount to keep them happy.
- C) Acknowledge the concern, then offer a conditional trade: "If you can commit to a longer term, we can reduce the rate."

3

A partner says, "That may be somewhat difficult for us." What does it most likely mean?

- A) Yes, definitely.
- B) Probably "no," or there's a real problem: ask gently.
- C) They didn't understand you.

4

You're not sure what someone's communication norms are. What's the best approach?

- A) Use your own norms: they're the same everywhere.
- B) Start more formal, observe and mirror, and ask when you're unsure.
- C) Use lots of idioms to sound friendly.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ rate my own business-communication toolkit and choose two areas to improve

- ◆ ☐ describe how workplace norms can vary, as tendencies, without stereotypes
- ◆ ☐ adapt an opening, an email and a request for a formal, relationship-first team
- ◆ ☐ recognize a soft "no" and respond politely
- ◆ ☐ run a meeting opening, a pitch and a negotiation in one connected scenario
- ◆ ☐ plan and rehearse a 5-minute capstone pitch with a clear call to action

◆ MY USEFUL PHRASES

◆ MY JOURNAL: MY ACTION PLAN

My two strongest areas are ____ and _____. For my two weakest areas, my habits are: ____ and _____. I'll check my progress on (date) _____.

HOW YOUR WORK IS SCORED

You get two scores: **Writing /20** (the proposal and the letter or email) and **Speaking /20** (the negotiation, the pitch and the interview together). Each uses the same four criteria, scored from 1 to 5: **Task & Purpose** (did it achieve the goal?), **Register & Tone** (the right formality and politeness), **Language Range & Accuracy** (phrases, grammar, vocabulary) and **Organization & Delivery** (structure, signposting, fluency, pronunciation, interaction). Your teacher returns your results privately within a week of Class 16. A score is a snapshot: look at the trend, and compare yourself with **you** in week 1.

◆ BEFORE CLASS 16: MY CHECKLIST

- ◆ ☐ My pitch notes fit on one card or one slide (keywords only).
- ◆ ☐ I rehearsed my pitch aloud twice with a 5-minute timer.
- ◆ ☐ My call to action is one clear sentence.
- ◆ ☐ I have answers ready for two objections.
- ◆ ☐ My interview preparation sheet is complete (two STAR stories, one strength, two questions).
- ◆ ☐ My scored interview slot: _____

◆ MY PERFORMANCE PROFILE (FILL IN WHEN YOUR RESULTS COME BACK)

Criterion	Class 1 · W	Class 1 · S	Class 8 · W	Class 8 · S	Final · W	Final · S
Task & Purpose	/5	/5	/5	/5	/5	/5
Register & Tone	/5	/5	/5	/5	/5	/5
Language Range & Accuracy	/5	/5	/5	/5	/5	/5
Organization & Delivery	/5	/5	/5	/5	/5	/5
Total	/20	/20	/20	/20	/20	/20

W = Writing · S = Speaking. Copy these scores into your performance tracker.

The criterion that grew most: _____ · The criterion I'll work on next:

◆ MY ACTION PLAN

My main goal for English at work: _____

My two strongest areas: _____

Two areas to grow, and one habit for each:

1. _____

2. _____

A real situation in the next month where I'll use what I learned: _____

Who can give me feedback? _____ · I'll review this plan on (date): _____

◆ SOMETHING I CAN DO NOW

One thing I can do now that I couldn't do in week 1.

◆ A MESSAGE TO MYSELF

Read it before your next important meeting, presentation or interview.